Health Sciences

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam - Faculty of Science - Health Sciences - 2025-2026

Since 1900, life expectancy in the Netherlands has increased by 30 years. Only five of those years can be attributed to curative medicine; the remaining 25 years are due to public health and prevention measures.

The Master (M) Health Sciences is aimed at mastering knowledge and skills in analyzing complex health or health care problems and in contributing to the development and implementation of interventions or programs to solve these problems. Our master programme distinguishes itself by offering a broad range of specialisations which encompass key disciplines in Health Sciences. The cornerstone of our vision on education is to train the expert generalists or T-shaped professional; persons with a strong foundation in methods and trained in analytical thinking by specializing in a substantive sub-field within the health sciences. This means that the five specializations enable students to focus on a specific domain of Health Sciences and to develop a specific expertise related to methodology (e.g. various qualitative and quantitative methods), content knowledge (e.g. nutrition and infectious diseases, prevention, health promotion) context (Dutch or International, socioeconomic differences) and application (intervention, prevention and policy).

Info

Level	Master
Language	English
Duration	1 year
Type	Full Time
Credits	60 EC
Faculty	Faculty of Science

Teaching and examination regulation 2025-2026
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Health Sciences general programme (without specialisation)

Description

Subject to certain conditions, the student has the option of compiling a curriculum of his/her own choice, which deviates from the curricula prescribed by the programme. The concrete details of such a curriculum must be approved by the Examinations Board before starting the programme.

Programme Sections

- Health Sciences general programme (without specialisation) optional modules
- Health Sciences general programme (without specialisation) compulsory courses

Health Sciences general programme (without specialisation) optional modules

Description

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Containment Strategies of Infectious Diseases in Global Context	P1	6EC	AM_470127
Economic Evaluation	P1	6EC	AM_470828
Health Psychology	P1	6EC	AM_470730
Nutrition in Health and Disease	P1	6EC	AM_470841
Advanced Health Economics	P2	6EC	AM_470843
Advanced Statistics	P2	6EC	AM_470826
Health Promotion and Disease Prevention	P2	6EC	AM_470811
Health, Globalisation and Human Rights	P2	6EC	AM_470818
International Comparative Analyses of Health Care Systems	P2	6EC	AM_470820
Parasitology	P2	6EC	AM_470052
Policy, Management and Organisation in International Public Health	P2	6EC	AM_470819
Prevention and Policy	P2	6EC	AM_470823
Public Health Nutrition	P2	6EC	AM_470815
Regulation and Organisation of Health Care	P2	6EC	AM_470809
Advanced Health Law	P3	6EC	AM_470844
Communication Campaigns and Research	P3	6EC	AM_470129
Disability and Development	P3	6EC	AM_470588
Health Hackers: Oplossingen voor Complexe Public Health Vraagstukken	P3	6EC	AM_1313
Migration, Culture, Health and Research	P3	6EC	AM_470813
Nutrition and Infectious Disease	P3	6EC	AM_470816
Prevention of Mental Health Problems	P3	6EC	AM_470840

Health Sciences general programme (without specialisation) compulsory courses

Description

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Internship Health Sciences	Ac. Year (September)	27EC	AM_1115
Research Methods for Health Sciences	P1	6EC	AM_1255
Scientific Writing in English	P4+5+6	3EC	AM_1159

Health Sciences specialisation Health Policy

Description

This specialisation is intended for students with a BSc degree related to Health Sciences who want to specialise in the field of policy and organisation of health care. The programme gives a broad overview of different aspects of the policy and organisation of health care; health economics, international comparisons, economic evaluations, cost-effectiveness studies, systematic reviews and the practical implications of legal rules and legal developments.

This specialisation consists of some compulsory and some optional courses as well as a research project (internship). Details can be found in the TER of the MSc Health Sciences of this academic year.

Programme Sections

- Health Sciences specialisation Health Policy constrained choice
- Health Sciences specialisation Health Policy compulsory modules
- Health Sciences electives all specialisations
- Health Sciences compulsory courses all specialisations

Health Sciences specialisation Health Policy constrained choice

Description
Students are required to choose at least one of these courses.

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Advanced Statistics	P2	6EC	AM_470826
Regulation and Organisation of Health Care	P2	6EC	AM_470809
Advanced Health Law	P3	6EC	AM_470844

Health Sciences specialisation Health Policy compulsory modules

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Economic Evaluation	P1	6EC	AM_470828
Advanced Health Economics	P2	6EC	AM_470843

Health Sciences electives all specialisations

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Health Hackers: Oplossingen voor Complexe Public Health Vraagstukken	P3	6EC	AM_1313
Migration, Culture, Health and Research	P3	6EC	AM_470813

Health Sciences compulsory courses all specialisations

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Internship Health Sciences	Ac. Year (September)	27EC	AM_1115
Research Methods for Health Sciences	P1	6EC	AM_1255

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Scientific Writing in English	P4+5+6	3EC	AM_1159

Health Sciences specialisation Infectious Diseases and Public Health

Description

This specialisation is intended for students with a BSc degree related to Health Sciences who want to specialise in infectious diseases within Health Sciences. The programme gives a broad overview of the biology of pathogenic organisms, the interaction between pathogens and their hosts and has a special focus on the epidemiology and control of infectious diseases.

Students who want to follow the specialisation Infectious Diseases and Public Health are strongly advised to have included the course Infectieziekten (code 471024) in their Bachelor programme.

For a specialisation 3 courses (see below) plus Scientific Writing in English and an internship within this field are obligatory (together at least 48 credits). The rest of the programme can be filled in freely within the general requirements for the MSc Health Sciences programme. In the internship students will focus on one or more of these aspects of infectious diseases.

Programme Sections

- Health Sciences specialisation Infectious Diseases and Public Health constrained choice
- Health Sciences specialisation Infectious Diseases and Public Health compulsory modules
- Health Sciences electives all specialisations
- Health Sciences compulsory courses all specialisations

Health Sciences specialisation Infectious Diseases and Public Health constrained choice

Description

Students are required to choose at least one of these courses.

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Containment Strategies of Infectious Diseases in Global Context	P1	6EC	AM_470127
Advanced Statistics	P2	6EC	AM_470826

Health Sciences specialisation Infectious Diseases and Public Health compulsory modules

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Parasitology	P2	6EC	AM_470052
Nutrition and Infectious Disease	P3	6EC	AM_470816

Health Sciences electives all specialisations

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Health Hackers: Oplossingen voor Complexe Public Health Vraagstukken	P3	6EC	AM_1313
Migration, Culture, Health and Research	P3	6EC	AM_470813

Health Sciences compulsory courses all specialisations

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Internship Health Sciences	Ac. Year (September)	27EC	AM_1115
Research Methods for Health Sciences	P1	6EC	AM_1255
Scientific Writing in English	P4+5+6	3EC	AM_1159

Health Sciences specialisation International Public Health

Description

The programme of the master specialisation International Public Health (IPH) aims to enable graduates to obtain the knowledge and skills to analyse complex international health problems and to identify, assess and design interventions from an interdisciplinary perspective. The master programme prepares graduates for a career as a scientific researcher, policy maker, advisor or manager in the field of international public health at a university, research institute, ministry, industry, non-governmental or international organisation.

The Master specialisation International Public Health is a one-year programme and consists of 60 credits. The course language is English. For a specialisation degree 3 courses (total 18 credits) plus an internship (total 27 credits) within this field are compulsory.

Programme Sections

- Health Sciences specialisation International Public Health constrained choice
- Health Sciences specialisation International Public Health compulsory modules
- Health Sciences electives all specialisations
- Health Sciences compulsory courses all specialisations

Health Sciences specialisation International Public Health constrained choice

Description

Students are required to choose at least one of these courses.

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Health, Globalisation and Human Rights	P2	6EC	AM_470818
International Comparative Analyses of Health Care Systems	P2	6EC	AM_470820
Disability and Development	P3	6EC	AM_470588
Nutrition and Infectious Disease	P3	6EC	AM_470816

Health Sciences specialisation International Public Health compulsory modules

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Containment Strategies of Infectious Diseases in Global Context	P1	6EC	AM_470127
Policy, Management and Organisation in International Public Health	P2	6EC	AM_470819

Health Sciences electives all specialisations

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Health Hackers: Oplossingen voor Complexe Public Health Vraagstukken	P3	6EC	AM_1313
Migration, Culture, Health and Research	P3	6EC	AM_470813

Health Sciences compulsory courses all specialisations

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Internship Health Sciences	Ac. Year (September)	27EC	AM_1115
Research Methods for Health Sciences	P1	6EC	AM_1255
Scientific Writing in English	P4+5+6	3EC	AM_1159

Health Sciences specialisation Nutrition and Health

Description

The specialisation Nutrition and Health is intended for students with a BSc degree in Health and/or life Sciences who want to discover the role of diet in health and in disease. Admission conditions can be found in the TER of this academic year.

At the start of this programme you should have basic knowledge and insight at BSc level, and hold a professional, academic attitude. In addition, prior knowledge and skills at the level of the BSc courses ‘’voeding en gezondheid’’ en ‘’voedingsonderzoek in de praktijk’’ are required.

In this specialisation you are trained to become a nutrition scientist. You acquire specialised knowledge on the relation between nutrition and health, are able to identify, and judge scientific evidence for nutrition and health related research, and assess the implications of nutrition research for future research and policy. Students can choose their own focus within the programme. For example, students can concentrate on the promotion of good health through primary and secondary prevention of nutrition related illness in the population (prevention); on nutritional problems in the clinical setting (clinical nutrition); on nutrition and infectious diseases; and/or on nutritional problems in developing and developed countries. Students are free to support their focus by choosing one or two optional courses from other programmes. Students can choose an internship project that fits their interest. Also international internships are possible within this programme.

In this specialisation we focus on nutrition and health, but at the end of this master’s programme the acquired skills can be applied also to other settings/fields within Health Sciences as well. Alumni from this programme work in different institutes, e.g. GG&GD, TNO, RIVM, food industry, hospital, universities, university medical centers, KIT, RIVM, WHO.

This specialisation consists of some compulsory and some optional courses as well as a research project (internship). Details can be found in the TER of the MSc Health Sciences of this academic year.

Programme Sections

- Health Sciences specialisation Nutrition and Health constrained choice
- Health Sciences specialisation Nutrition and Health compulsory modules
- Health Sciences electives all specialisations
- Health Sciences compulsory courses all specialisations

Health Sciences specialisation Nutrition and Health constrained choice

Description

Students are required to choose at least one of these courses.

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Advanced Statistics	P2	6EC	AM_470826
Nutrition and Infectious Disease	P3	6EC	AM_470816

Health Sciences specialisation Nutrition and Health compulsory modules

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Nutrition in Health and Disease	P1	6EC	AM_470841
Public Health Nutrition	P2	6EC	AM_470815

Health Sciences electives all specialisations

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Health Hackers: Oplossingen voor Complexe Public Health Vraagstukken	P3	6EC	AM_1313
Migration, Culture, Health and Research	P3	6EC	AM_470813

Health Sciences compulsory courses all specialisations

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Internship Health Sciences	Ac. Year (September)	27EC	AM_1115
Research Methods for Health Sciences	P1	6EC	AM_1255
Scientific Writing in English	P4+5+6	3EC	AM_1159

Health Sciences specialisation Prevention and Public Health

Description

The specialisation Prevention and Public Health is suitable for those who want to specialise in health promotion and disease prevention. Admission conditions can be found in the current TER.

At the start of this module, we expect students to master knowledge, insight, attitude and skills at a level which is comparable to the final qualifications stated by the Bachelor Health Sciences at the VU. Furthermore, prior knowledge and skills comparable to the objectives of the BSc courses ‘Preventie’ and ‘Gezondheidscommunicatie’ are required.

Within this specialisation you are trained to become a health promotor who is able to work in a theory- & evidence-based way and is able to link research, practice and policy. The programme addresses knowledge, attitude and skills related to the development, evaluation and implementation of health promoting interventions aimed at lifestyle changes in several domains. Theories, methods and strategies at both the individual and the environmental level will be addressed. In addition, attention is given to prevention approaches at the individual and policy level and within different settings.

The courses within this specialisation are related to the six steps of Intervention Mapping to ensure coherence in the program. These steps are: 1) Needs assessment, 2) Preparing matrices of change objectives, 3) Selecting theory-informed intervention methods and practical applications, 4) Producing program components and materials, 5) Planning program adoption, implementation, and sustainability and 6) Planning for evaluation.

This specialisation consists of some compulsory and some optional courses as well as a research project (internship). Details can be found in the TER of the MSc Health Sciences of this academic year.

Programme Sections

- Health Sciences specialisation Prevention and Public Health compulsory modules
- Health Sciences specialisation Prevention and Public Health constrained choice
- Health Sciences electives all specialisations
- Health Sciences compulsory courses all specialisations

Health Sciences specialisation Prevention and Public Health compulsory modules

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Health Promotion and Disease Prevention	P2	6EC	AM_470811

Health Sciences specialisation Prevention and Public Health constrained choice

Description
Students are required to choose at least two of these courses.

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Health Psychology	P1	6EC	AM_470730
Prevention and Policy	P2	6EC	AM_470823
Communication Campaigns and Research	P3	6EC	AM_470129
Prevention of Mental Health Problems	P3	6EC	AM_470840

Health Sciences electives all specialisations

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Health Hackers: Oplossingen voor Complexe Public Health Vraagstukken	P3	6EC	AM_1313
Migration, Culture, Health and Research	P3	6EC	AM_470813

Health Sciences compulsory courses all specialisations

Courses

Course Name	Period	Credits	Code
Internship Health Sciences	Ac. Year (September)	27EC	AM_1115
Research Methods for Health Sciences	P1	6EC	AM_1255
Scientific Writing in English	P4+5+6	3EC	AM_1159

Courses

Advanced Health Economics

Course Code	AM_470843
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	drs. F. Amankour
Examiner	prof. dr. A.H.E. Koolman
Teaching Staff	prof. dr. A.H.E. Koolman, dr. F.R.M. Portrait
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Computer lab, Written partial exam, Lecture

Course Objective

The objective of this course is twofold: (1) to increase skills of health economic analysis to enable the study of health policy from an economic perspective and (2) to develop knowledge of health economics required to understand (Dutch) health policy.

This course mainly focuses on health economics needed to optimize healthcare system performance.

This course deals with the following issues:

- What are the goals of a health system?
- How may these goals be measured?
- Under what conditions may markets contribute to these goals?
- Why are healthcare costs growing so fast?
- What is practice variation and how may it be controlled?
- How may healthcare costs be controlled?

Upon completion of this course, the student:

1. can describe possible causes for health care expenditure rise and appraise (create) possible policy options to bend this curve.
2. can describe possible causes of demand and supply driven practice variation and evaluate possible options to reduce this.
3. can apply economic theory to analyze and evaluate competition in different health (sub)markets.
4. can differentiate health systems goals, analyze and evaluate health systems in terms of efficiency and equity in health and healthcare use.

Course Content

The theoretical part of this course is largely based on the last edition (Volume 2) of the Handbook of Health Economics. This part will be discussed both in lectures and (computer assisted) workgroups. The latter will be used mostly to practice specific analytic skills required for the written exam.

For the empirical part, students will create groups to perform a longitudinal analysis of healthcare cost development in OECD countries. This analysis will involve the quantitative skills of the preceding course "Care and Prevention Research" and will lead to a policy oriented paper and a presentation.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Lectures, workshops and computerpracticals totaling 50 hours.

Method of Assessment

The final grade will be based on a written scientific policy report (1/3) and written examination (2/3). The final grade is the weighted average of the two marks.

Entry Requirements

(Introduction in) health economics

Literature

Handbook of Health Economics, Edited by Mark V. Pauly, Thomas G. Mcguire and Pedro P. Barros (PDF-provided by the VU)

Additional Information Target Audience

Students participating in the master Health Sciences. The course is compulsory for students who enrolled in the specialization Policy and Organization of Healthcare

Additional Information

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Recommended background knowledge

Courses of the bachelor curriculum: (Introduction in) health economics

Advanced Health Law

Course Code	AM_470844
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	Dutch
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. mr. V.E.T. Dörenberg
Examiner	dr. mr. V.E.T. Dörenberg
Teaching Staff	dr. mr. V.E.T. Dörenberg
Teaching method(s)	Seminar, Excursion

Course Objective

De student:

- heeft kennis van de werking van gezondheidswetgeving in de praktijk, op een niveau dat hij/zij kan reflecteren op de doelen en doelbereiking van een wet;
- heeft kennis van evaluatie van wetgeving in de zorg, op een niveau dat hij/zij a) de kenmerken en succes- en faalfactoren kan benoemen en b) de meest gebruikte methode van onderzoek (reconstructie van de beleidstheorie en analyse van de praktijk) kan toepassen op een wet of onderdeel daarvan;
- kan beargumenteren wat in de context van een specifiek thema op het gebied van de organisatie en financiering van zorg óf de kwaliteit van zorg en toezicht de knelpunten zijn en hiervoor juridische oplossingsrichtingen aandragen.

Course Content

Tijdens de bacheloropleiding Gezondheidswetenschappen heb je kennis kunnen maken met het vakgebied gezondheidsrecht. Dit vakgebied omvat alle regels die van belang zijn voor de gezondheidszorg en de volksgezondheid. Gezondheidsrechtelijke regels zijn te vinden in Europese regelgeving, Nederlandse wet- en regelgeving en uitspraken van rechters en tuchtcolleges. Ook producten van zelfregulering en opvattingen in de literatuur zijn bronnen van gezondheidsrecht.

Het gezondheidsrecht is een relatief jong en dynamisch vakgebied en heeft een sterke binding met de ethiek van de zorg. Vanwege veranderende sentimenten of maatschappelijke ontwikkelingen vinden regelmatig wetswijzigingen plaats en worden wetsvoorstellen ingediend bij de Tweede Kamer. Voorbeelden van omvangrijke wetswijzigingen zijn de stelselherzieningen in de langdurige zorg en de jeugdhulp. Denk daarnaast ook aan de jarenlange discussie over het wijzigen van het publiekrechtelijk geregelde tuchtrecht voor de gezondheidszorg.

In deze verdiepingscursus wordt verondersteld dat je globale kennis hebt van de kenmerken van het gezondheidsrecht en van de belangrijkste rechtsbeginselen die binnen dit vakgebied gelden. Centraal staat vervolgens de werking van gezondheidswetgeving in de praktijk. Wat zijn de effecten van gezondheidswetgeving, hoe kun je dit onderzoeken en wat valt er te verbeteren aan specifieke wetgeving om een bijdrage te leveren aan het oplossen van bestaande knelpunten? Achtereenvolgens behandelen we in de cursus: juridisch-empirisch onderzoek in de zorg (1ste week), organisatie en financiering van zorg (2de week), kwaliteit van zorg en toezicht (3de week).

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Op grote lijnen:

- verplichte werkcolleges met voorgeschreven literatuur;
- vrijwillige spreekuren op maandagochtend in 2de en 3de week van de cursus;
- vrijwillige excursie naar Regionaal Tuchtcollege Amsterdam op dinsdagmiddag in 2de of 3de week van de cursus;
- vrijwillige feedbackmomenten voor groepsopdrachten en individuele opdracht in 3de en 4de week van de cursus.

Contacturen: gemiddeld 10 uur per week.

Method of Assessment

De leerdoelen worden getoetst in drie opdrachten: twee groepsopdrachten en een individuele opdracht.

De groepsopdrachten tellen elk voor 25% mee in de eindbeoordeling; peer en self-assessment zijn onderdeel van de beoordeling van de groepsopdrachten (methode Goldfinch).

De individuele opdracht telt voor 50% mee in de eindbeoordeling.

Voor alle opdrachten moet het cijfer 5,5 of hoger worden gescoord om de cursus succesvol af te ronden; compensatie is dus niet mogelijk.

Literature

De literatuur voor de werkcolleges zal via hyperlinks (of anders rechtstreeks) in Canvas te raadplegen zijn.

Additional Information

Het betreft een keuzevak in de master Health Sciences, specialisatie Health Policy.

Taal: Nederlands

Vaste docenten: mr. dr. V.E.T. Dörenberg (vakcoördinator en examinator), mr. dr. B.J.M. Frederiks.

Gastdocenten (opgave onder voorbehoud!): prof. mr. M.C. Ploem e.a.

Dit vak voor het laatst aangeboden binnen de MSc Health Sciences in academisch jaar 2025-2026

Advanced Statistics

Course Code	AM_470826
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. F.C.M. van Leth
Examiner	dr. F.C.M. van Leth
Teaching Staff	dr. F.C.M. van Leth
Teaching method(s)	Seminar, Computer lab, Lecture

Course Objective

Background: students from the Master Health Sciences continue to have a wide variety of professional careers in- and outside of academia. Handling and interpretation of data will play an important role in many of these settings. This course provides a first introduction to advanced topics in data analysis that are likely to be encountered when working in the field of health sciences.

After this course, you will understand the basic principles of working with clustered data, longitudinal data, and time components in your data. You will be able to apply theoretical concepts to actual data analysis. Furthermore, you can present data analysis results in an engaging and concise manner, and geared towards to your relevant audience. The premise for all this work is that your primary research question drives your methodological and analytical choices, an important concept that will be reinforced during the course.

Intended learning outcomes:

After completing this course you should be able to

- explain and apply the basic principles analyzing clustered data
- explain and apply the basic principles analyzing longitudinal data
- choose and apply appropriate methods for accounting for time in your analysis
- present findings from a data analysis assignment around any of the above topics
- reflect on choices in data analysis approaches in the field of health sciences

Course Content

This course provides a first introduction to advanced topics in data analysis that you will likely encounter when working in the field of health sciences. We will explore the identification and handling of clustered data that challenge the assumptions of standard statistical techniques. We will also focus on the analysis of longitudinal data that are seen frequently in the field of health sciences, and especially how we can account for time in the analysis.

Although the course expands knowledge of, and hands-on experience in analytical techniques, it has not the aim to make you an expert in these topics. This course does provide you with the confidence to engage in discussions surrounding complex analytical approaches in the field of health sciences.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Lectures: approximately 24 hours Work groups: approximately 24 hours Individual assignment: approximately 24 hours Preparation and self-study.

Method of Assessment

Written exam (75%)
Data analysis assignment (25%)

Presentation of individual assignment (pass / fail)

You should have at least a 5.5 for the each of the written exam and the data analysis assignment, and a “pass” for the presentation in order to complete the course successfully.

Entry Requirements

You must have adequate knowledge of epidemiology and standard analytical techniques including regression.

Literature

- lecture notes
- applicable literature provided during the course

Recommended textbooks:

- Twisk JWR. Applied longitudinal data analysis for epidemiology. A practical guide. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, UK, 2003.
- Twisk JWR. Applied multilevel analysis. A practical guide. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, UK, 2006

Additional Information Target Audience

This course is aimed at students from the Master Health Sciences.

Additional Information

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Communication Campaigns and Research

Course Code	AM_470129
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	A.M.M. Leroux MSc
Examiner	dr. E.F. Droog
Teaching Staff	dr. I.E. Vermeulen, dr. J. Veldhuis
Teaching method(s)	Computer lab, Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

In this course students will gain an understanding of:

- Communication theory and theories of persuasion that relate to mass and new media health campaigns
- How to analyze campaign content in terms of message factors and communication strategies
- How to develop and deliver mass media and new media communication campaign messages
- How to evaluate the effects of a media health campaign (by using quantitative methods)
- How to advise institutions about (the implementation of) mass and new media communication campaigns

Course Content

This course, fits in the program of the specialization Prevention and Public Health. Within this specialization you are trained to become a health promotor who is able to work in a theory- & evidence-based way and is able to link research, practice and policy.

In this course, students will learn about the creation of theory-based health communication campaigns, how to analyze the effect of such campaigns, reflect on the communication strategies used in health campaigns, advise institutions on campaign strategies and prepare for campaign evaluation. In course readings and lectures, students read and apply relevant communication theory (e.g. about theories of persuasion and message factors like framing, fear appeals, evidence, and affect). Students will learn more about both the intended and unintended effects of campaigns and how to understand and measure these effects. Furthermore, we will pay particular attention to the use of mass and new media for health campaigns and how to target particular risk groups.

The course will culminate in assignments in which students will combine theory, research and practice. Students will reflect on real-life health campaigns in terms of the communication strategies and message factors used to achieve the campaigns' aims and reach specific target groups. In one of the assignments, theory-based hypotheses will be articulated and tested using a real-world dataset. There will be attention for planned development and evaluation of communication strategies. The course will include some 'hands-on practice' with

evaluation analyses as well, which eventually lead to reflecting on the campaign-of-interest, and use their insights on communication strategies to advise the campaigns' health organization to further improve their intervention.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

This course is rewarded with 6 ECTs.

Communication Campaigns and Research is a full-time course, this means that 42 hours a week are necessary to pursuit the goals of this course.

Regular attendance during the weeks is mandatory.

Teaching activities include: lectures (L), work group meetings (W), project work, consultation hours, and feedback on assignments (PRO), and computer practica (PRA).

Method of Assessment

The course entails an individual assessment that counts for 50% of the final grade of this course. An assignment conducted in small groups counts for 50% of the final grade of this course. To pass this course you have to have at least a 5.5 for both the individual assessment and the group assignment.

Entry Requirements

At the start of this course, we expect you to master knowledge, insight, attitude and skills at a level which is comparable to the final qualifications stated by the Bachelor Health Sciences at the VU.

Literature

Obligatory literature will be provided through a literature list consisting of scientific articles in the course manual (and Canvas).

Additional Information Target Audience

MSc Health Sciences

Additional Information

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Custom Course Registration

Registration for this course via VU-net.

Recommended background knowledge

Basic experience with SPSS. The following course of the Master health sciences is strongly recommended: ‘Health Promotion and Disease Prevention’.

Containment Strategies of Infectious Diseases in Global Context

Course Code	AM_470127
Credits	6
Period	P1
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. D.R. Essink
Examiner	dr. D.R. Essink
Teaching Staff	dr. D.R. Essink
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

The endpoint of this course is that the student

- Has acquired in-depth theoretical and practical knowledge in relation to health intervention strategies for infectious diseases.
- Has acquired insights in various infectious diseases and characteristics in relation to containment strategies.
- Has acquired insight into the role of international institutions, such as the WHO, governmental advisory bodies, relevant professionals, executing institutions, NGOs and communities in designing and carrying out health interventions.
- Understands which barriers are important when implementing containment strategies of infectious diseases, with a focus on vaccination programs.
- Has acquired insight in theoretical concepts and methods to interpret results, evaluations and the effectiveness of programs.
- Has learned and practiced interdisciplinary methods and techniques to plan health interventions at community level in an interactive way.
- Is able to communicate results by means of an evidence based policy brief, a video and orally

Course Content

The COVID-19 pandemic is clear evidence that this course has been and still is relevant. This course focuses on the design and implementation of intervention strategies used to address infectious diseases in a global context. The approach taught to
design interventions is also applicable beyond the domain of infectious disease control.
The containment strategies to be discussed include programmes for known infections (including vaccination strategies and
in case of absence of a vaccine, diagnosis and treatment strategies, environmental and social control strategies) and emerging infections (including isolation, prevention and communication strategies).
The student learns how to analyze bottlenecks and opportunities of the various strategies, how to interpret the results and to evaluate the implementation of programmes.
In addition, the student will take part in a group assignment on how to design containment strategies at community level in an interactive way, for e.g. tuberculosis, polio, rabies, malaria, HIV/AIDS, Ebola, etc. A video presentation and writing of a policy brief will be part of the group assignment.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Lectures, group assigment, (video) presentation, essay, self-study. Basic background knowledge will be provided by VU lecturers, whereas relevant guest lecturers will present practical field examples.

Group assignment attendance is compulsory.

Contact hours: lectures 34 hrs, group work 8 hrs.
Self-study approx. 80 hrs.

Method of Assessment

Individual exam (60%) and group assignment presentation and policy brief (40%).
Both parts must at least be sufficient (6 or higher)

Entry Requirements

Basic knowledge about the pathogenesis of infectious diseases, microbiology and immunology

Literature

BOOK: Webber, Roger. Communicable diseases: a global perspective. Cabi, 2019.
or
R. Webber, 2016. Communicable diseases: a global perspective. ISBN 9781780647425 / DOI 10.1079/9781780647425.0000

Lecture Slides: Slide of lectures as made available on Canvas.

Additional readings: Lecturers may make further readings available on Canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

Compulsory course within the Master differentiation International Public Health; optional course for students in other differentiations of the Masters Health Sciences, Biomedical Sciences, and Management, Policy Analysis and Entrepreneurship in Health and Life Sciences. Students from other backgrounds, please contact our secretariat for further information at secretariaat.athena@vu.nl

Additional Information

VU lecturers:
Prof. dr. Aura Timen
Dr. Dirk Essink

Guest lecturers:
Dr. M. Gidado (KNCV)
Dr. Constance Schultsz (AIGHD/AMC)
Prof. dr. Maarten Postma (RUG)
Dr. Koert Ritmeijer (MSF)
Prof. dr. Cees Hamelink (VU)
Prof. dr. Ron Fouchier (EMC Rotterdam)
Dr. Hans Zaaijer (Sanguin)
Aula Abara, Msc. (MSF)
and others

Custom Course Registration

Enrollment through Canvas.

Disability and Development

Course Code	AM_470588
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. R.M.H. Peters
Examiner	dr. R.M.H. Peters
Teaching Staff	dr. R.M.H. Peters
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

- To define the concepts of 'impairment', ‘disability’ and ‘inclusive development’ using examples
- To explain the complex two-way relation between disability and poverty
- To explain the issues and barriers faced by people with disabilities in the global context
- To demonstrate with examples the importance of the UN Convention for the Rights of Persons with Disabilities and the SDG Framework for the field of disability and development
- To apply and compare relevant theories, models and frameworks related to disability (e.g. medical model, social model, ICF model, ecological system theory, twin-track approach, stigma, intersectionality, epistemic injustice).
- To design and assess studies related to disability (including participatory approaches) and interventions.
- To apply research skills during the problem-based learning sessions (e.g., participating in scientific discussions, formulating of research objectives, literature research, abstracting, summarizing and giving feedback on findings, drawing conclusions)

Course Content

The Disability and Development (D&D) course focuses on a broad range of issues related to disability in the global context. Disability affects an estimated 1.3 billion people worldwide. With trends such as aging, medical advances, population growth, shifting disease burden and the climate crises these numbers are expected to increase. About 80% of the persons with disabilities live in low and middle income countries. In countries with life expectancies over 70 years, individuals spend on average 8 years living with disabilities. Across the globe, a substantial number of people with disabilities have limited access to education, employment and health (rehabilitation) services. They also may have to deal with stigmatization, social exclusion and discrimination.

The United Nations Convention to the Rights of People with Disabilities (UNCRPD) has been crucial for the promotion of disability-inclusive development. This treaty was adopted in 2006 and has 164 signatories as of 2022. Parties that signed the convention are required to promote, protect, and ensure the full enjoyment of human rights by persons with disabilities. They also need to ensure that people with disabilities enjoy full equality under the law. Making the goals set out by the UNCRPD a reality is work in progress. Also the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) framework, with its commitment “to leave no one behind” has been crucial. The framework explicitly

emphasizes including people with disabilities in terms of education, employment and research, reducing inequality, and creating inclusive communities. In 2019, heads of state and government representatives adopted the political declaration: “Universal health coverage: moving together to build a healthier world”. This declaration includes a specific reference made to persons with disabilities. In 2021 a landmark resolution was adopted by the World Health Assembly, on “The highest attainable standard of health for persons with disabilities”, which aims to advance the agenda of disability inclusion in the health sector in countries, and focuses on three central areas: i) access to effective health services; ii) protection during health emergencies; and iii) access to cross-sectorial public health interventions.

This course will cover essential knowledge and skills in the field of Disability in the Global Context.

Students are encouraged to think critically, ethically, holistically, rationally, and collegially about topics addressed in this 4 week course programme, such as:

- Epistemic Injustice
- Disability Models and other relevant theories
- Intersectionality
- Global Mental Health
- Disability and Sexuality
- Role of families
- Gender
- Violence
- Researching Disability and Stigma
- Disability Rights
- Activism
- Migration
- Child exploitation and the NGO perspective

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Problem-based learning supported by lectures.

- Lectures: 21 hours
- Tutorial groups: 21 hours
- A few optional oral exam preparation sessions
- Self-study + portfolio : remaining hours

Method of Assessment

- Oral examination (60%)
- Portfolio (30%)
- Participation in the tutorial group work (10%)
- Peer feedback (sufficient/ insufficient)

For all parts, a passing grade (> 5.5) needs to be obtained in order to successfully finish the course.

Entry Requirements

Bachelor-level education; any subject

Literature

See Canvas for suggested readings

Additional Information Target Audience

The Disability & Development module is an optional course for Master students Management, Policy Analysis and Entrepreneurship in Health and Life Sciences (MPA), Health Sciences (HS), Global Health (GH) and Biomedical Sciences (BMS).

Additional Information

For more information contact Dr. Ruth Peters (r.m.h.peters@vu.nl)

Economic Evaluation

Course Code	AM_470828

Credits	6
Period	P1
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. H.M. Broulikova MSc
Examiner	prof. dr. J.E. Bosmans
Teaching Staff	dr. H.M. Broulikova MSc, M.J.E. Greuter, dr. J.M. van Dongen, prof. dr. J.E. Bosmans
Teaching method(s)	Computer lab, Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

After finishing the course Economic Evaluation the student has obtained knowledge of HTA research and specifically economic evaluations. The students are able to choose between a trial-based or model-based study to answer their research question. The student is aware of the challenges associated with performing economic evaluations and is able to design an economic evaluation while taking into account these challenges. The student is able to analyze, interpret and report cost-effectiveness data from trial- based and model studies. Finally, the student is able to critically read and judge the quality of cost-effectiveness trials and model studies.

Course Content

The course will include the following topics:

- Aims of economic evaluations
- Types of economic evaluations
- Measuring, valuing and analyzing costs
- Quality of life, utilities and QALYs
- Monetary valuation of informal care and productivity losses
- Bootstrapping
- Incremental cost-effectiveness ratios
- Cost-effectiveness planes
- Cost-effectiveness acceptability curves
- Net-benefit framework
- Sensitivity analysis
- Decision tree analysis
- Markov modelling
- Probabilistic sensitivity analysis
- Interpretation and reporting of results of economic evaluations
- Use of cost-effectiveness information in health care policy

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Lectures (17) combined with computer practicals (33 hours), workshops (10 hours). Please note that you will need your own laptop for the computer practicals.

Method of Assessment

Two assignments, stakeholder debate and a written examination. The first assignment will be graded with a grade between 1 and 10, and constitutes 40% of the final grade. The second assignment and participation in the stakeholder debate will be graded as sufficient/insufficient. Both assignments should be sufficient (first assignment grade >=5.5, second assignment sufficient) to pass the course. A written examination will account for 60% of the final grade, and should be graded >= 5.5 as well.

Literature

- Gray AM, Clarke PM, Wolstenholme JL, Wordsworth S. Applied Methods of Cost-effectiveness Analysis in Health Care. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Additional literature on Canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

Students following the master Health Sciences and other interested master students. R and Excel will be used in the course during the computer practicals.

Additional Information

Lecturers: Prof. Judith Bosmans, Dr. Veerle Coupé, Dr. Hana Broulikova and several guest lecturers

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Recommended background knowledge

Basic knowledge in using Excel and willingness to learn R is expected. The students are asked to install R before the start of the course. VU IT Service Desk is available in case the students need assistance with installation (servicedesk.it@vu.nl or 020 598 0000). Students who are beginners in R are encouraged to follow a short online introduction in R before the course (of their choice, suggestions available at Canvas).

Health Hackers: Oplossingen voor Complexe Public Health Vraagstukken

Course Code	AM_1313
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	Dutch
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M. Campos Ponce
Examiner	dr. M. Campos Ponce
Teaching Staff	prof. dr. C.M. Renders, M.J. Bouma MSc, dr. L.A. Schaap
Teaching method(s)	Seminar, Study Group, Other, Symposium, Lecture

Course Objective

Tijdens deze cursus bereiden studenten zich voor op hun professionele rol als gezondheidswetenschapper. Zij zullen in een multidisciplinair team werken aan oplossingen voor een complex volksgezondheids vraagstuk uit het werkveld.

Leerdoelen:

Na het volgen van deze cursus kan de student:

1. De rol van verschillende gezondheidsdisciplines begrijpen en benutten bij het aanpakken van een complex volksgezondheidsvraagstuk uit het werkveld;
2. Een probleemanalyse opstellen passend bij een complex volksgezondheidsvraagstuk uit het werkveld;
3. Op heldere en professionele wijze mondeling en schriftelijk rapporteren over een complex volksgezondheidsvraagstuk en bijbehorende mogelijke aanpak, passend bij het publiek;
4. Reflecteren op de multidisciplinaire samenwerking en de eigen rol daarin;
5. Reflecteren op persoonlijke ontwikkelpunten gericht op de rol als gezondheidswetenschapper bij de aanpak van een complex volksgezondheidsvraagstuk

Course Content

Tijdens deze cursus werken studenten actief aan de ontwikkeling van hun professionele identiteit, door zich te verdiepen in realistische en complexe vraagstukken op het gebied van volksgezondheid, afkomstig uit de praktijk. Deze verdieping vindt plaats via masterclasses, literatuuronderzoek en interactieve dialoogsessies met relevante stakeholders.

Daarnaast doen studenten ervaring op met samenwerken in multidisciplinaire teams en versterken zij hun professionele vaardigheden, zoals effectief samenwerken, leiderschap, overtuigend presenteren en visueel communiceren, binnen de zogenoemde Skills Labs.

De cursus wordt afgesloten met een ‘Summit’ op de laatste vrijdag, waar studenten hun eindproducten presenteren. Deze eindproducten kunnen verschillende vormen aannemen, zoals een debat, podcast, persconferentie, mini-documentaire of een beleidsadvies.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Colleges (6 uur), verplichte werkgroepen (16 uur), vaardigeheden workshops (16 uur)

Method of Assessment

- Eindproduct van complex volksgezondheids vraagstuk (60%)
- Presentatie op Summit (40%)
- Reflectie (voldoende/onvoldoende)

Om de cursus te halen, moeten alle cijfers 5,5 of hoger zijn en moet de reflective met een voldoende worden afgesloten.

Entry Requirements

De toelatingseisen voor deze cursus zijn dezelfde als voor het MSc Health Sciences programma

Literature

Het cursusmateriaal zal bestaan uit (wetenschappelijke) artikelen en boekhoofdstukken die beschikbaar worden gesteld op de Canvas-pagina van de cursus Health Hackers

Additional Information Target Audience

Het is een optionele cursus binnen het MSc-programma Health Sciences

Custom Course Registration

Dit is een pilot cursus in 2025-2026. Voor deze cursus geldt dit jaar een minimaal aantal deelnemers van 10 en een maximaal aantal van 30 studenten. Bij minder dan 10 inschrijvingen kan de cursus komen te vervallen. Bij meer dan 30 aanmeldingen wordt deelname bepaald op basis van volgorde van inschrijving, tenzij anders aangegeven.

Health Promotion and Disease Prevention

Course Code	AM_470811
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M.C. Adriaanse
Examiner	dr. M.C. Adriaanse
Teaching Staff	dr. M.C. Adriaanse, E.L. Ibouanga MSc
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

General aims

In this course, the students will learn to:

1. Provide a solid basis in understanding elementary aspects of evidence- and theory-based development and planning of health promotion and disease prevention programs.
2. Write a scientific study protocol about the planned development and evaluation of a preventive health intervention.

Learning objectives

After the course, students:

- Are able to describe and apply the elementary aspects of evidence- and theory-based development and planning of health promotion and disease prevention programs using an intervention mapping approach
- Are able to apply theoretical methods that can help to change important determinants of the environment and or health behaviors (lifestyle factors)
- Have knowledge about and is able to apply strategies that provides opportunities and challenges for the development and implementation of preventive health interventions, such as:

- Environment, habits and self-regulation
- Community action
- Interventions in public space
- Evaluating effects

- Are able to describe, understand and discuss the fundamental aspects of quality of life such as measurements, types and criteria
- Are able to describe the principals and perspectives of implementation and process-, effect and economic evaluation of health promotion programs
- Are able to integrate the acquired knowledge of the course in writing a study protocol

Course Content

This course fits in the program of the specialization Prevention and Public Health. Within this specialization you are trained to become a health promotor who is able to work in a theory- & evidence-based way and is able to link research, practice and policy. The courses within this specialization are structured according to the six steps of Intervention Mapping. These steps are:

1. Needs assessment;
2. Preparing matrices of change objectives;
3. Selecting theory-informed intervention methods and practical applications;
4. Producing program components and materials;
5. Planning program adoption, implementation, and sustainability;
6. Planning for evaluation.

The course Health Promotion and Disease Prevention will introduce you to the six steps of Intervention Mapping. Specific emphasize will be put on step 2 and 3 with a focus on primary prevention.

This course focuses on lifestyle/ health behaviors and environmental differences related to health and diseases among individuals and populations. The ultimate goal is to improve peoples' health status and quality of life by health promotion interventions.
Some examples of the topics that will be addressed are:

- Intervention mapping; designing theory- and evidence-based health promotion programs.
- Theory-based intervention methods and strategies; theoretical methods that can help to change several of the most important determinants of health behaviors.
- Environmental influences on health. The physical environment and health interact. The importance of environmental interventions and their effect on health are postulated.
- Health-related quality of life; the role of perceived mental and physical health status in the development of interventions.
- Effect and process evaluation; principals, perspectives on process evaluation, and determining the effects of health promotion programs.

Core element in this course is writing a study protocol in English, describing the design of a health promoting or disease preventing intervention trial.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

This course is rewarded with 6 ECTs and runs in Nov-Dec 2025. Health Promotion and Disease Prevention is a part-time course, this means that 21 hours a week are necessary to pursuit the goals of this course.

Teaching activities include: Lectures, tutorials, guest lecturers, group assignment (study protocol), peer review sessions and self-study.

Method of Assessment

Grades will be based on the assignment (study protocol) and a written exam that includes multiple choice and open-ended questions. The final grade is being determined by the study protocol (30%) and written exam (70%). The study protocol as well as the written exam must have a grade 5.5 or higher.

Entry Requirements

At the start of this course, we expect you to master knowledge, insight, attitude and skills at a level which is comparable to the final qualifications stated by the Bachelor Health Sciences at the VU.

Literature

The following book is used by students who follow the specialization Prevention and Public Health. Bartholomew, Eldredge, Parcel, Kok, Gottlieb, Fernandez (eds) Planning health promotion programs: an intervention mapping approach; fourth edition(2016). Jossey-Bass, San Fransisco. ISBN:978-1-119-03549-7. Chapters which are applicable to this course will be announced through Canvas. In addition, students will use a course manual, and additional course materials are provided via Canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

The course ‘Health promotion and disease prevention’ is a compulsory course within the Master Health Science specialization Prevention and public health, and an elective course for students of other specializations of the master Health Sciences. Students with a Bachelor degree or pre-masters in Health Sciences with interest in the field of prevention and public health.

Additional Information

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Custom Course Registration

Registration for this course via the registration module on your VU Dashboard. Registration for the assignment in subgroups and the workgroups via Canvas.

Recommended background knowledge

Students are expected to comprehend the knowledge of the VU bachelor health science courses ‘Preventie’ and ‘Gezondheidscommunicatie’, or the VU premaster health science course ‘Preventie en volksgezondheid’ or similar courses on other universities.

Health Psychology

Course Code	AM_470730
Credits	6
Period	P1
Course Level	400
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. B.M. van Dongen
Examiner	dr. B.M. van Dongen
Teaching Staff	dr. B.M. van Dongen, E.L. Ibouanga MSc
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

- Students can explain what the field of health psychology is about in the context of tertiary prevention and which psychological aspects are relevant in the treatment of diseases and coping with chronic diseases.
- Students can recognize and explain the fundamental elements, underlying theory and evidence-based of the following central psychological aspects: hospitalization and stressful medical procedures, coping, self-management, adherence, social support, doctor-patient communication, health literacy and relapse.
- Students can explain the relationships and differences between these aspects and can provide suggestions on how to influence these aspects in an evidence-based manner in the context of tertiary prevention.
- Students are able to recognize aspects in the reality of patients and can reflect on these aspects if and in what way real-life experiences are in accordance with the theory of the chosen concept.
- Students are able to develop a feasible and scientifically supported mHealth (mobile/app) intervention plan aimed at improving self-management, coping and/or adherence

Course Content

This course fits in the program of the specialization Prevention and Public Health. Within this specialization you are trained to become a health promoter who is able to work in a theory- & evidence-based way and is able to link research, practice and policy.

Health Psychology refers to the psychological aspects of health, illness and the health care system. In the current course ‘Health Psychology’, key psychological aspects that are relevant in the treatment of diseases and coping with chronic diseases will be studied and discussed, as well as the way we can influence these aspects. As such, this course focusses on tertiary prevention, e.g. the prevention of worsening of (chronic) diseases and improving self-reliance of patients. Questions to be studied will be for example ‘How can we improve adherence of patients with diabetes with regard to their medication?’, and ‘How can we improve communication between health care workers and their patients?’. These and other questions will be studied in several cases about key psychological aspects, which will be applied to real-life practice of patients (individual) and intervention development (group) through practical assignments. The first step will be to study underlying determinants or psychological processes of the (health) problems. Second, interventions to tackle the presented problems or research into the different problems will be studied.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

This course is rewarded with 6 ECTs. Health Psychology is a part-time course, this means that 21 hours a week are necessary to pursuit the goals of this course. Attendance is mandatory for all patient-guest speakers.

During the course ‘Health Psychology’ you will obtain knowledge and understanding of:

1. Hospitalization and stressful medical procedures;
2. Coping with diseases;
3. Self-management interventions in chronic illness;
4. Adherence to advice and treatment
5. Communication processes between health care workers and their patients;
6. Health literacy and its influence on coping/ self-management
7. The role of social support
8. Relapse in health-related behavior among patients

The course is built around these topics, which will be discussed and studied during seminars. In preparation for these seminars, literature and knowledge clips need to be studied. You will use the information from the seminars to fulfill two assignments: The objective of the first assignment is to get insight into the link between theory and practice. You will link theory to personal experiences of patients who suffer from a chronic disease to reflect on lived experiences in relation to the theory. The objective of the second assignment is to learn how to develop the outlines of an evidence-based (mHealth) intervention idea in the context of tertiary prevention using Intervention Mapping.

Method of Assessment

In order to pass for the course, you must:

1. Attend all guest lectures by patients (pass/fail);
2. Pass an individually written report reflecting on key psychological aspects based applied to the experiences of the guest lecturers and the theory around these aspects (pass mark is 5.5 or higher);
3. Write a scientific report for the systematic development of an M-health Intervention. You will carry out this assignment in groups (pass mark is 5.5 or higher);

The final mark for the course is determined by:

- Assignment 1 (50%) – an individually written report based on guest lectures by patients;
- Assignment 2 (50%) – a combined grade based on the scientific report the intervention plan and a peer-assessment score.

Information regarding the resit of the assignments will be announced later through Canvas.

Entry Requirements

At the start of this course, we expect you to master knowledge, insight, attitude and skills at a level which is comparable to the final qualifications stated by the Bachelor Health Sciences at the VU.

Knowledge about theories and models with respect to psycho-social determinants of behavior is necessary, including knowledge on differences between health, health behavior and determinants of behavior and familiarity with central behavioral determinants.

Literature

The following book is required for students who follow the specialization Prevention and Public Health:

- Bartholomew Eldredge, Parcel, Kok, Gottlieb, Fernandez (eds). Planning health promotion programs: an intervention mapping approach; fourth edition (2016). Jossey-Bass, San Fransisco. ISBN: 978-1-119-03549-7 (E-book also available)

Other literature, such as book chapters and articles, will be announced on Canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

Master students Health Sciences. All other students need approval of the course coordinator and the examination committee of their own program.

This course will be taught in in English, with the exception of one guest lecture by a patient.

Additional Information

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Custom Course Registration

Registration for this course via VU-net*.

*Note: final division in workgroups will be done in the first week of the course and teachers reserve the right to make this division based on group work. Registration for workgroups in VU-net will NOT be leading.

Health, Globalisation and Human Rights

Course Code	AM_470818
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	400
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. D.R. Essink
Examiner	dr. D.R. Essink
Teaching Staff	
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

The student;

- Is able to describe, understand and apply human rights concepts in a global context
- Develops a deeper understanding and a critical attitude towards scientific literature in the field of health, globalization and human rights in order to formulate soundly argued positions
- Is able to create his/her own vision with regard to the socio-cultural dimensions of human rights values in relation to public health
- Is able to apply methods of human rights assessment in relation to innovations in health care
- Demonstrates the ability to write and present according to academic standards

Understand and apply scenario making in the context of human rights oriented global health futures

To understand and apply (research) ethics in global health

Course Content

This course focuses on the human rights issues that are raised around the globe in connection with global health concerns. The course introduces the students to the effects of globalization on health issues, to the relevant UN human rights instruments on health and to the mechanisms to promote and protect these rights. Attention is given to a wide range of human rights topics in which health and well being play a crucial role. Examples are situations of armed conflict, reproductive rights, migration and refugee issues and children's rights. Within the context of current globalization processes the importance of local cultural insights into the human rights & global health interaction will be discussed. During the course students will prepare and participate in a scenario/simulation exercise on a human rights assessment of innovations in health technology and discuss relevant scientific literature in study groups. During the course students consistently reflect on human rights and research ethics in the context of global health. In the exam students will show their creative problem-solving skills applying them to human rights dilemmas in public health.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Contact hours

Lectures: 33 hours
Work groups: 12 hours
Group project, simulation and exam: 11 hours

Self study and preparing: remaining hours

Method of Assessment

Group projects (40%), exam (60%).

All parts need to be passed (6.0) (the exam is an essay written or oral)

Literature

Hamelink, C. J., Essink, D. R., & Visser, M. J. (Eds.). (2024). Global Health and Human Rights: Principles and Practices. Taylor & Francis.

To be announced at the start of the first work group/lecture and via Canvas for group project.

Additional Information Target Audience

Compulsory course for research master global health students. Optional course for students in all specializations of the Masters Health Sciences, Biomedical Sciences and Management, Policy Analysis and Entrepreneurship in the Health and Life Sciences.

Additional Information

For more information contact Ona Ilozumba (ona.ilozumba@vu.nl)

International Comparative Analyses of Health Care Systems

Course Code	AM_470820
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	prof. dr. J.E.W. Broerse
Examiner	prof. dr. J.E.W. Broerse
Teaching Staff	K.E. Mujica Gastelbondo MSc, prof. dr. J.E.W. Broerse, dr. D.R. Essink
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Written partial exam, Lecture

Course Objective

At the end of this course students are able to:

- Describe health systems, including its goals and functions, and illustrate how such systems can be analysed, compared, and reformed;
- Recognise the value of using a systems perspective and the complexity of comparing culturally diverse health systems;
- Design methodologies for comparative analyses, including the selection of countries, primary outcomes, conceptual frameworks, and indicators;
- Critically analyse and compare the health systems of two high-income countries (HICs) and two low-and middle-income countries (LMICs) on selected topics, using relevant research questions, publicly available sources, frameworks, outcomes, and qualitative and quantitative indicators;
- Differentiate between comparative health system analyses in HICs and LMICs and identify the unique challenges involved in their comparisons;
- Synthesise findings from comparative analyses in a clear and concise manner (abstracts and indicator tables);
- Perform an outlier analysis using statistical software (for MSc Global health students only);
- Develop and conduct presentations (lecture and poster presentation) about synthesised comparative results;
- Work as effective team members and collaborate with fellow students in two group assignments;
- Assess the work of your own group and those of other students and give constructive feedback.

Course Content

Until recently, the field of global health mainly embraced disease-specific initiatives and focused on the delivery of health services for specific diseases, as well as their lifestyle, environmental and socioeconomic determinants. After decades of such disease-specific initiatives, it is now recognised that programmes solely targeting the prevention or treatment of specific diseases cannot yield the desired outcomes in the context of weak health systems. Recent pandemics have emphasised the role of health systems in global situations even more. A critical determinant of health, as well as the success of global health initiatives, is the health system as a whole. Recognition of this brought ‘strengthening of health systems’ onto the global health agenda and into funding

schemes.

The global health researchers and professionals of this era need to have a good understanding of health systems and the key skills to analyse and compare them in order to; adapt themselves to the different health systems in which they will work; analyse different health systems and identify how they have evolved to this point and in which areas; and determine how they can be strengthened to improve its outcomes.

Serving these purposes, this course aims to equip students with the knowledge and skills related to concepts, theory and methods on the following key areas:

- What a health system is (and different ways of describing it)
- What goals and functions health systems have
- Why and how health systems and their performance can be analysed and compared
- Why and how health systems evolve and can be reformed

In line with these, the course will cover low, middle income countries (LMICs) and high-income countries (HICs) and span across different health system goals (health gain, equity, responsiveness, and effectiveness and efficiency) and functions (stewardship, financing, resource generation, and health services).

In terms of methodology, students learn to use the case study approach for carrying out a comparative analysis. Students will be acquainted with the theory of case studies via lectures and reflection sessions and will implement this method during two group assignments. Both qualitative and quantitative aspects of ‘health systems comparison’ are discussed and critiqued. Furthermore, the complexity and culturally determined nature of health system design and health system reform are presented through a series of lectures form VU-lecturers and experts from a variety of institutions such as the Dutch Royal Tropical Institute (KIT). Case examples and what we can learn from this about (strengthening) health systems will also be discussed.

Small group work for the assignments provides opportunities to practice relevant skills by analysing, first, the health system of two selected HICs according to a defined theme (e.g. mental health, or primary care). Groups will present their findings with a lecture. Subsequently, health systems of two LMICs with comparable financial resources (e.g. GDP per capita, per capita health expenditure, etc.) but different health outputs and outcomes are analysed to find out why two countries are performing in such different ways. The findings will be presented in a poster format. By repeating the analysis on the same theme but with different countries, the students are challenged to constantly improve their own analysis process.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Teaching methods include lectures by VU teachers and guest lecturers, lectures by other students, workgroups for assignments, problem-driven learning, self-study. The total study time of 168 hours is distributed as follows:

- Lectures ~ 21hrs
- Lectures and practicals on epidemiology & statistics ~19hrs (for MSc Global Health students only)
- Workgroup meetings with coaches ~ 11hrs
- Workgroup work on assignments ~ 58hrs
- Self-study ~ 50 hrs
- Student lectures & poster presentation ~8hrs
- Exam 2,25hrs

Attendance to the workgroup meetings (including feedback sessions), students' lecture presentations and poster presentations are compulsory.

Method of Assessment

The grading of the course is based on Assignment 1, Assignment 2 and the exam:

- Assignment 1: group lecture (pass/fail)
- Assignment 2: group poster presentation (40%)
- Exam: individual assessment (60%)

Each part will be assessed over 100pts and take place on Campus. All parts need to be passed (minimum grade 5.5).

Literature

A selection of literature will be made on the basis of lectures and state of the art research. A selection of last year’s literature is listed below.

- Mills & Ranson (2012) The design of health systems.
- World Health Organisation (2011) World Health Report 2000: Health Systems: Improving Performance. (Chapter 1, Chapter 2 and the Statistical Annex)

- Yin RK. Case Study Research: Design and Methods. Sage publications 2018, London. (Chapters 1 and 2)
- World Health Organisation (2006) Working together for health
- Brito Fernandes et al. (2021) Engaging citizens in the development of a health system performance assessment framework: a case study in Ireland Health Research Policy and Systems 19:148
- Plsek PE, Greenhalgh T. Complexity science: The challenge of complexity in health care. Brit Med J. 2001;323(7313):625-8.
- Grin J & Broerse JEW (2017) Introduction. In: Broerse, J.E.W. & Grin J. (eds.) Toward Sustainable Transitions in Healthcare Systems. New York: Routledge
- Van Raak R & de Haan FJ (2017) Key Features of Modern Health Systems: Nature and Historical Evolution. In: Broerse, J.E.W. & Grin J. (eds.) Toward Sustainable Transitions in Healthcare Systems. New York: Routledge
- Fadele KP, et al (2024) Mental health challenges in Nigeria: Bridging the gap between demand and resources. Global Mental Health, 11, e29, 1–5

Additional Information Target Audience

- Compulsory course within the Master specialisation International Public Health
- Compulsory course for 1st year Research Master Global Health students
- Optional course within the Master specialisation Infectious Diseases (master programme Biomedical Sciences).

In any other circumstances admission should be requested from the coursecoordinator.

Recommended background knowledge

It is strongly recommended that students have knowledge on public health and/or public policy in the context of health and/or care.

Internship Health Sciences

Course Code	AM_1115
Credits	27
Period	Ac. Year (September)
Course Level	600
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M.A.G. Kuipers
Examiner	dr. M.A.G. Kuipers
Teaching Staff	dr. M.A.G. Kuipers, M.J. Bouma MSc, L. Bergsma MSc
Teaching method(s)	Seminar, Lecture

Course Objective

At the end of the research internship, the student is able to conduct a scientific research project under supervision and able to:

- Formulate a rigorous research question
- Find scientific information independently
- Select adequate literature relevant for a specific research question
- Apply rigorous scientific methods to answer a specific research question
- Draw conclusions that are supported by the data
- Write a final thesis in the format of a scientific article in English
- Collaborate with other professionals e.g. researchers, policy makers
- Orally present the research results and discuss the findings in English

Course Content

The research internship is an important and compulsory part of the MSc program Health Sciences in which the student carries out a scientific study and writes a paper on the findings. The internship has to be preceded by a research proposal. The research internship involves many different aspects, such as theoretical preparation, literature study, data analysis, report writing, oral presentation, and participation in the scientific activities of a research department.

Internships can be done at various locations. An internship is described as internal when the internship takes place at a department of the VU Amsterdam or Amsterdam UMC (location VUmc or AMC). All other internships are

referred to as external and can be both in the Netherlands or abroad, for example at research institutes (e.g. RIVM, NIVEL), other universities, hospitals or other health care institutions, municipal health services, or health insurance companies.

The research internship period is five months and regular start dates are in the beginning of February and March (exact dates can be found in the Internship Manual MSc Health Sciences on Canvas).

Additional Information Teaching Methods

During this internship you will conduct a scientific research project under the supervision of a VU-supervisor and, in case of external internships, an on-site supervisor.

Method of Assessment

Six weeks after the start of the internship a go/no go evaluation with the VU supervisor together with the student (and if applicable the on-site supervisor), will take place. The aim of this go/no go evaluation is to decide whether the research project and the student both have enough potential to continue (Go) or not (No Go). The evaluation is based on:

- The written introduction and methods sections of the thesis
- The attitude of the student and execution of the project during the first six weeks.

At the end of the internship, the VU-supervisor (and if applicable with input from the on-site supervisor) will assess the written thesis, the execution of the research project and the attitude of the student. An independent second reader will assess the written thesis as well. The presentation will be graded by two independent assessors. The final mark for the research internship is based on the following weighted grades:

- An individually written thesis (scientific article) in English: 60% of final mark
- Oral presentation on research project in English for an academic audience: 20% of final mark
- Execution of the research project: 20% of final mark
- Attitude (pass/fail)

In order to pass, the student needs at least a 6 out of 10 for manuscript, presentation and execution (no compensation), and a pass for attitude.

Entry Requirements

The following admission requirements have to be met in order to start the internship:

1. At least 18 EC (= pass 3 courses) from the MSc Health Sciences program
2. One of these courses should be Research Methods for Health Sciences (first course of the MSc programme Health Sciences)

Additional Information Target Audience

Students of the Master Health Sciences

Additional Information

More detailed information about the internship can be found in the Internship Manual of the MSc Health Sciences (VU) of the current academic year on Canvas. For questions, please send an email to masterhealthsciences.agw.beta@vu.nl.

Custom Course Registration

The research proposal preceding the internship has to be approved by the MSc Internship coordinator and the VU-supervisor before a student may start the internship. The Internship Manual (see Canvas) describes the process of completing the internship from the beginning (the admission) through the actual execution to the assessment.

Migration, Culture, Health and Research

Course Code	AM_470813
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	600
Language Of Tuition	English

Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	S.E. Duijs
Examiner	S.E. Duijs
Teaching Staff	M. Overman, S.E. Duijs, N.S. Goedhart, dr. M.E. Muntinga
Teaching method(s)	Seminar, Study Group

Course Objective

The Master course “Migration, Culture, Health & Research” offers you knowledge and skills on migration and culture in relation to health, with a strong focus on qualitative research.

After following this course:

1. You will have knowledge about health issues related to migration and the influence of culture on experiencing health, illness and care
2. You are able to reflect on concepts including diversity, intersectionality and cultural sensitivity in relation to migration, culture and health, and to reflect on your own background, experiences and viewpoints on such topics
3. You will have knowledge about various qualitative research approaches in relation to migration, culture and health
4. You are able to apply knowledge about qualitative research into a qualitative research proposal and to reflect on the quality and accountability of research on migration, culture and health and your role as a researcher

Course Content

This course addresses migration, culture and ethnicity as essential concepts in doing research in the field of health sciences in our diverse world. The main focus in the course lies on understanding the experiences of people with diverse migration/cultural/ethnic backgrounds through qualitative research. Through various lectures, research workshops and assignments the course explores the challenges of doing inclusive, socially and scientifically relevant and responsive research.

This is a 4-week course and each week focuses on different themes. Below, you can find the (preliminary) program:

week 1: introduction & diversity, intersectionality
week 2: migration, health and research
week 3: culture, ethnicity, health and research
week 4: quality and reflexivity in research & course wrap-up

Additional Information Teaching Methods

- Lectures (6)
- research workshops (6 hrs)
- work group/ peer group meetings (16 hrs)
- individual/ group assignment work (108 hrs)
- self study (32 hrs)

Attendance of the research workshops and workgroup sessions is compulsory.

Method of Assessment

Assessment is based on the following assignments:

- writing a research proposal & critical appraisal of an article (60%)
- writing blog posts (20%)
- designing and facilitating a workshop (20%)

The final grade for each of the assignments should be at least a 5.5 to successfully complete the course.

Entry Requirements

A Bachelor's degree in health, life or social sciences.

Literature

Reading materials for this course consist out of scientific articles and book chapters, which will be provided on Canvas.

For each of the lectures the required reading materials include two or three articles/ chapters. Recommended

optional materials (readings, video's etc) will also be provided on Canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

health & life sciences, social sciences, global health research, (international) public health, medical science

Additional Information

Main lecturers: Dr Saskia Duijs & Dr Maaike Muntinga, both working at the Department of Ethics, Law and Humanities of Amsterdam UMC (VUmc)

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Custom Course Registration

Signing up for work groups takes place on Canvas. Make sure to do this before the first day of the course.

Explanation Canvas

All information related to the course will be placed on Canvas. Canvas is also used as the main way of communication throughout the course.

Nutrition and Infectious Disease

Course Code	AM_470816
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M. van der Hoeven
Examiner	dr. M. van der Hoeven
Teaching Staff	dr. M. van der Hoeven
Teaching method(s)	Computer lab, Seminar, Study Group, Written partial exam, Lecture

Course Objective

The focus of this course is on the interactions between malnutrition and infection in a global context, both key concerns in vulnerable populations. This course will use examples of infections in relation to nutritional status outcomes to illustrate how:

- infection contributes to the etiology and pathogenesis of malnutrition
- malnutrition impacts the host defense mechanisms and vulnerability to infection.

This course has been designed to enable students to critically appraise literature, employ epidemiological methods and prepare students for their MSc internship. Students will use a guided self-study approach to learn the principles of nutrition and infectious diseases.

At the end of the course the student can:

- Choose and present scientifically, in depth, a biological mechanism relevant to both nutrition and infectious disease.
- Employ epidemiological methods to describe and understand risk factors related to nutrition and infectious disease.
- Develop an appropriate study design for a research question related to infectious disease and nutrition.
- Run analyses on one of the several public available datasets in order to answer the research question and to present the results.
- Answer a research question, following proper code of conduct with regards of responsible research and ethical guidelines

Course Content

The course has a strong international focus and will cover key nutritional concepts related to global trends, with a focus on the nutritional concerns of vulnerable populations. The course will focus on both epidemiology and biological pathways. The inter-relationship between infection and both under-nutrition as well as nutrition related

chronic disease is of increasing importance and will be emphasized. In addition, this course helps students to prepare for the MSc Internship; the different assignments contribute to refreshing and adding to knowledge on literature appraisal, study designs, ethical considerations and research integrity, and statistical analysis. During the data analysis assignment students will be encouraged to assume the role of a public health researcher, where an one pager/abstract on the conducted research must be written.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

The focus of this full time course is on guided student learning. The first two weeks will include lectures followed by discussion groups and in-class assignments. The remainder of the course will be focused on individual as well as group projects and data analysis. Students will be expected to demonstrate an in-depth understanding of nutrition and infectious disease. Tuition methods include: • Lectures (30 hours) • Discussion groups and in-class assignments (20 hours) • Data analysis: individual and group project (70 hours) • Self-study (40 hours)

Method of Assessment

The course grade is based on presentations, peer reviews and written assignments. To pass the course, all grades have to be 5.5 or above and the peer review must be concluded with a pass.

- escape room (optional)
- written take-home assignment (35%)
- biological mechanism video presentation (10%)
- data analysis assignment (45%)
- presentation of the data analysis assignment (10%)
- peer review (pass/fail)

Entry Requirements

The admission requirements for this course are the same as for the MSc Health Sciences programme:
You will need to have at least a Bachelor’s degree from an accredited research university including at least three full years of academic study amounting to a minimum of 180 ECTS or equivalent.

Specific admission requirements for the MSc Health Sciences programme:

1. Adequate knowledge in health and/or life sciences
2. 6 ECTS in Epidemiology
3. 12 ECTS in Biostatistics
4. 30 ECTS Biology

Literature

Course reading material will consist out of scientific articles and book chapters which will be provided on the Canvas page of Nutrition and Infectious Disease.

Additional Information Target Audience

This is a full time course in period 3 and compulsory for Infectious Diseases and Public Health specialization students. It is an optional course within the MSc programme of Health Sciences.

Additional Information

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Nutrition in Health and Disease

Course Code	AM_470841
Credits	6
Period	P1
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. E. Leistra
Examiner	
Teaching Staff	dr. A.M.M. Vaes, prof. dr. ir. M. Visser, I. Veldman MSc, dr. H.A.H. Wijnhoven, prof. dr. ir. I.A. Brouwer, dr. E. Leistra
Teaching method(s)	Computer lab, Seminar, Study Group, Practical, Lecture

Course Objective

After finishing this course students can place nutrition in the context of the prevention and treatment of disease and students have more in-depth knowledge of different research designs in the field of clinical nutrition research. This course will focus on nutritional physiology, body composition, disease-related and age-related nutritional syndromes and different study designs in clinical nutrition research.

Information will be illustrated with diverse patient groups, varying from early life until old age, and addressing both chronic and acute/clinical disease. The specific knowledge will be applied in an assignment in which students will design a research proposal. This course supplies the knowledge and competence needed to perform nutrition research in (a public health setting and/or) a clinical setting.

Course Content

- (Patho)physiology of the gastrointestinal tract
- Body composition in health and disease
- Energy and protein metabolism and requirements in health and disease
- Disease-related and age-related (mal)nutrition syndromes
- Nutrition in early life
- Nutrition in sports
- Rules and regulations in clinical nutrition research
- Identifying relevant research designs for clinical nutrition research
- Designing a research protocol
- Interpreting (validity of) body composition measurements

Additional Information Teaching Methods

6 ECTS (=168 hours): (guest) lectures and workshops (~1 ECTS), group assignments (~3 ECTS), self-study (~2 ECTS).

Method of Assessment

(Group) assignments: body composition (~20%) and research proposal (~30%); and written exam (~50%). All parts should be 5.5 or higher in order to pass the course.

Entry Requirements

BSc courses ‘Voeding’ (AB_1166) and ‘Voedingsonderzoek’ (AB_1175) or PreMSc course ‘Voedingsleer en Onderzoek’ (AP_470902), or equivalent level. Students should have basic knowledge of statistics and epidemiology and the principles and methods of observational studies and experimental studies. Following Research Methods for Health Sciences (AM_1255) parallel to this course is strongly advised. If you do not meet these prerequisites, contact the course coordinator.

Literature

Specific readings (e.g. scientific papers) for lectures are provided separately via Canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

MSc students Health Sciences (compulsory course for the specialisation 'Nutrition and Health').

Additional Information

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Custom Course Registration

Registration for group assignments via Canvas

Parasitology

Course Code	AM_470052
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	400
Language Of Tuition	English

Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M.R. van Dijk
Examiner	dr. M. van der Hoeven
Teaching Staff	dr. M. van der Hoeven, dr. M. Campos Ponce, dr. M.R. van Dijk, dr. J.R. Haanstra
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Practical, Lecture

Course Objective

This course aims to provide students with a wide knowledge and understanding of medical parasitology. The course focuses on:

- Parasites and their virulence;
- Transmission;
- The role of parasites and host(s) on the outcome of disease;
- Immunological aspects;
- (Laboratory) diagnosis of parasites;
- Epidemiology, treatment, prevention and control of parasitological diseases.

Course Content

This course will focus on Medical Parasitology.

The lectures will provide an overview of parasites that are of medical importance, focussing on:
parasite life cycles; interactions between parasites and their host(s) (e.g. invasion, survival, immune modulation and underlying molecular mechanisms);
diagnosis (development and application); hygiene hypothesis; epidemiology; treatment; prevention (including vaccines); control and elimination.
The majority of the lectures will be given by some of the top researchers and professors within the field of parasitology in the Netherlands, Belgium and Unganda.
These expert guest speakers will provide you with a broad overview of what is happening in this field.
The lectures will be interactive and should therefore be prepared by reading the corresponding literature. Your input in the lectures will be of utmost importance.

Specific teaching goals:

After this course you will have learned the principles of medical parasitology and will be able to:

- Apply these principles to different parasite groups;
- Describe parasite life cycles using correct terminology;
- Identify the role of the host and parasite (virulence factors) on the outcome of an infection and disease;
- Describe the underlying molecular mechanisms involved in parasite infection;
- Describe different diagnostic techniques and their respective advantages and disadvantages;
- Describe and discuss the principles for treatment, prevention, control or eradication programmes for parasite infections of medical importance;
- Analyse, discuss and present literature in the parasitology research field;
- Make suggestions for future parasitological research

Furthermore, this course includes academic and professional skills development in all five areas of competence: 1) communication skills, 2) ethical skills, 3) teamwork- and interpersonal skills, 4) problem-solving and analytical skills, and 5) technical/computer skills.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

This course will include interactive guest lectures covering all aspects of medical parasitology. This will be followed by discussion groups, peer learning by using the online tool Perusall, and in-class assignments, in which you will be expected to demonstrate an in-depth understanding of the course content and literature. You will also have the opportunity to identify several parasites in a practical session. In the final week you will (within a group) present a grant application on a parasite of choice during an elevator pitch or prepare and actively participate in a debate on a selected parasitological topic. All workgroup-sessions are compulsory.

An written examination will take in week 7. Lectures: 31 hours Workgroups: 20 hours Practical parasite identification: 4 hours

Method of Assessment

You will pass the course if you have attended all compulsory sessions, if all assignments are sufficient and the exam is above 5,5 (so not 5,4!).

Entry Requirements

Solid knowledge on basic cell biology, basic immunology and the basics of infectious diseases is compulsory before the start of the course.

Literature

On Canvas

Additional Information Target Audience

MSc programme Health Sciences, specialization Infectious diseases and Public Health, optional course within the MSc programmes of Biomedical Sciences.

Additional Information

Several guest lecturers will be invited to teach on Medical Parasitology.

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Explanation Canvas

All communication will be via Canvas. It is recommended to check Canvas regularly for the latest updates.

Policy, Management and Organisation in International Public Health

Course Code	AM_470819
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M.O. Kok
Examiner	dr. M.O. Kok
Teaching Staff	dr. M.O. Kok, dr. A.M.C. Loeber
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

- To develop a detailed understanding of the health policy process and its outcomes both at national and international level
- To acquire insight into different theoretical concepts on policy design in the field of public health
- To understand how policy decisions in the health sector are translated into concrete programs and projects, and subsequently implemented
- To get acquainted with different management and governance practices in health programs
- To get acquainted with and acquire skills in international health diplomacy, resolution writing, negotiation and the UN procedures of the World Health Organization

Course Content

This course contains two core parts that will run parallel throughout the course: a theoretical part and a practical, diplomacy, part. In the theoretical part you study different theoretical concepts of policy science in international public health. You study core concepts of public administration in relation to IPH such as power relations, securing public interest, public versus private sector, managing change and the network society. Questions are addressed such as: In what way does the political structure of a country influence health policies; Why do certain topics get on the policy agenda while other topics never make it; Why do policy makers and politicians regularly seem to ignore scientific insights; To what extent do international organizations (such as the World Bank and the World Health Organization) influence national policies? To link these the theoretical insights to concrete examples, all students will have to read the book 'Wisdom of Whores', which traces the response to the HIV/AIDS epidemic. In the diplomacy part you develop basic diplomatic skills by practicing them in 4 training sessions and a final 1.5 day World Health Organization simulation under Model United Nations rules of procedure (WHO MUN). Model United Nations (informally abbreviated as Model UN or MUN) is an academic simulation of the United Nations that aims to

educate you about civics, effective communication, globalization and multilateral diplomacy. In Model UN, you take on roles as foreign diplomats and participate in a simulated session of the WHO.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Lectures (32 hours), training workshops (16 hours) and simulation (12 hours), self study (102,5 hours), and examination (2.5 hours)

Method of Assessment

Individual exam (70%) and diplomacy assignment (30%). Both grades need to be at least 5.5 to pass the course.

Literature

- "Making Health Policy", Kent Buse,Nicholas Mays & Gill Walt, 2005, Open University Press, ISBN 0-335-21839-3
- "The Wisdom of Whores", Elizabeth Pisani, 2008, Granta Publications, ISBN978-1-84708-076-9
- Other reading materials via Canvas

Additional Information Target Audience

Compulsory course within the Master specialization International Public Health; optional course for students in other specializations of the Masters Health Sciences and Biomedical Sciences.

Additional Information

Attendance of training workshops and simulation is compulsory.

For further information and application, please contact Maarten Kok (m.o.kok@vu.nl)

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Prevention and Policy

Course Code	AM_470823
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	Dutch
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. M.M. van Stralen
Examiner	dr. M.M. van Stralen
Teaching Staff	dr. M.M. van Stralen, E.L. Ibouanga MSc
Teaching method(s)	Computer lab, Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

Doel

Binnen deze cursus ontwikkel je inzicht in:

- Hoe nationaal en lokaal beleid op het gebied van gezondheidsbevordering en ziektepreventie wordt ontwikkeld;
- Hoe wetenschappelijke kennis over gezondheid en preventie kan bijdragen aan de ontwikkeling van beleid;
- Het belang van andere invloeden, stakeholders en verschillende perspectieven op gezondheid(bevordering) voor beleidsontwikkeling;
- Een multidisciplinair perspectief vanuit beleid, onderzoek en praktijk om effectieve communicatie en samenwerking te verbeteren tussen de verschillende sectoren;

Leerdoelen

Na het volgen van de cursus kan de student:

- Uitleggen en voorbeelden geven van de kracht van beleid om volksgezondheid en kansengelijkheid op nationaal en lokaal niveau te verbeteren;

- Uitleggen en voorbeelden geven van hoe het Nederlandse Volksgezondheidsysteem in elkaar zit;
- Beschrijven en uitleggen hoe de impact van beleid geëvalueerd kan worden en toepassen van beleidsinstrumenten om de impact van beleid op gezondheid te evalueren;
- Integraal gezondheidsbeleid en het belang hiervan beschrijven, uitleggen en toepassen op een complex gezondheidsprobleem;
- Uitleggen en voorbeelden geven van theorieën en kernelementen van het beleidsvormingsproces en toepassen van deze theorieën op de Nederlandse situatie;
- Uitleggen en voorbeelden geven van de invloed van de wetenschapper op het beleidsvormingsproces;
- Beschrijven van (problemen in) volksgezondheid vanuit het perspectief van onderzoek, beleid en praktijk, en vanuit verschillende perspectieven op volksgezondheid;
- Ontwerpen en onderbouwen van (beleid)maatregelen op gemeentelijk niveau die een leefstijlprobleem integraal aanpakken en dit opschrijven in een beleidsadvies.

Course Content

De verantwoordelijkheid voor de gezondheid is steeds meer bij het individu komen te liggen. We maken immers zelf onze leefstijlkeuzes, zoals wel of niet voldoende bewegen, gezond eten of roken. Toch komt er steeds meer bewustzijn dat ook andere partijen verantwoordelijk zijn voor het stimuleren van een gezonde leefstijl. Zoals het ministerie van Volksgezondheid, Welzijn en Sport in 2011 schreef in de landelijke nota gezondheidsbeleid ‘Gezondheid Dichtbij’: een gezonde leefstijl is nog steeds primair de verantwoordelijkheid van het individu, maar ook partijen zoals zorgverleners, zorgverzekeraars, scholen, werkgevers en de overheid spelen een rol in de bevordering van gezond gedrag. Deze partijen hebben de verantwoordelijkheid om een sociale, culturele, economische en fysieke omgeving op te bouwen waarin gezond gedrag de makkelijkste en aantrekkelijkste keus is voor het individu. Want zoals steeds meer duidelijk wordt: de omgeving heeft een minsten zo grote invloed op de gezondheid als het individu.

Tijdens de cursus Preventie en Beleid duiken we in de wereld van gezondheid- en preventiebeleid in Nederland. Je leert hoe beleid in Nederland wordt ontwikkeld en uitgevoerd – op nationaal niveau (overheid) en lokaal niveau (gemeenten een GGD’en) – en waarom gezondheidsbeleid belangrijk is en wat het kan doen voor de volksgezondheid. Daarnaast leer je hoe wetenschappelijke kennis over gezondheid en preventie kan bijdragen aan de ontwikkeling van beleid. Speerpunt van de cursus Preventie en Beleid is de aandacht voor de integrale aanpak: om tot effectief beleid te komen dat ook op lange termijn de volksgezondheid verbetert, moeten beleidsmakers, wetenschappers, burgers en alle relevante maatschappelijke en praktijkorganisaties samenwerken. Je leert daarom hoe je bij het ontwikkelen van een beleidsmaatregel rekening moet houden met de impact van de maatregel op alle betrokkenen – de stakeholders –, welke belangen zij hebben bij het beleid, en welke rol zij spelen in de uitvoering van het beleid. Je leert, in andere woorden, om multidisciplinair na te denken vanuit het perspectief van beleid, onderzoek en praktijk over gezondheid en gezondheidsbeleid.

De cursus Preventie en Beleid is een keuzevak binnen de specialisatie Prevention & Public Health in de master Health Sciences. Als gezondheidswetenschapper ambieer je wellicht een carrière binnen het onderzoek, beleid of de praktijk. Waar je ook terecht komt, er is altijd een wisselwerking (en bij voorkeur goede samenwerking) tussen deze verschillende sectoren. Evengoed blijft het een uitdaging binnen de gezondheidszorg om de sectoren samen te brengen. De cursus Preventie en Beleid helpt je om een interdisciplinaire blik te ontwikkelen, met een specifieke focus op het Nederlandse gezondheidsbeleid, zodat jij de interactie tussen de verschillende sectoren kunt verbeteren en toepassen in je werk. De andere vakken van de masterspecialisatie verdiepen zich, naast hun specifieke thema’s, in uitvoeren en ontwerpen van onderzoek en planmatige ontwikkeling programma’s voor gezondheidsbevordering en ziektepreventie.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

De cursus vindt plaats in periode 2. Voor de cursus kan 6 ECTS worden behaald. Het is een deeltijd-cursus die één periode (acht weken) duurt. Wekelijks wordt een tijdsinvestering van 21 uur verwacht.

In week 1 t/m 6 vinden wekelijks hoorcolleges en werkgroepen plaats. Op verschillende momenten in de cursus leveren de studenten een conceptversie in van een nieuw stuk van het verslag, waarop feedback gegeven wordt door de docenten. Voor deze deadlines worden spreekuren georganiseerd. In week 7 vindt een responsiecollege plaats en kan geleerd worden voor het tentamen. In week 8 vindt het tentamen plaats en wordt de eindversie van het verslag ingeleverd.

Tijdens deze cursus geven gastsprekers een college vanuit het RIVM, het ministerie van VWS, Pharos, een GGD en een gemeente. Daarnaast geven de cursusdocenten hoorcolleges en alle werkgroepen.

Method of Assessment

De studenten schrijven een verslag in groepsverband: een wetenschappelijk ontwikkeld beleidsadvies op gemeentelijk niveau, waarin advies wordt gegeven voor een integrale aanpak dat een specifiek gezondheidsprobleem binnen een gekozen gemeente moet aanpakken. Dit beleidsadvies wordt op planmatige wijze opgesteld middels het Intervention Mapping protocol; een “theory and evidence based” stapsgewijze aanpak voor de ontwikkeling van gezondheidsbevorderingsprogramma’s.

Het groepsverslag telt voor 50% mee in het eindcijfer, dit wordt bepaald door het groepscijfer en een peer-assessment score. Het individuele tentamen telt voor 50% mee in het eindcijfer. Beide onderdelen moeten minimaal met een 5,5 of hoger worden beoordeeld om het eindcijfer en de ECTS te behalen.

Entry Requirements

Er wordt verondersteld dat de student kennis, inzicht, attitude en vaardigheden bezit op het niveau van de Bachelor Gezondheidswetenschappen van de VU Amsterdam.

Literature

Tijdens deze cursus wordt het boek gebruikt dat tijdens Health Psychology in periode 1 is gebruikt.

Bartholomew Eldrigde LK, Markham CM, Ruiter RAC, Fernàndez ME, Kok G & Parcel GS (2016). Planning health promotion programs: an intervention mapping approach (4th edition). Hoboken, NJ: Wiley.

Verdere literatuur voor de praktische opdracht en als leerstof voor het tentamen wordt op Canvas geplaats.

Additional Information Target Audience

Masterstudenten Health Sciences.

Additional Information

De cursus wordt volledig in het Nederlands gegeven.

Dit vak voor het laatst aangeboden binnen de MSc Health Sciences in academisch jaar 2025-2026

Custom Course Registration

Registratie voor deze cursus verloopt via de standaard procedures via de intekenmodule op het VU Dashboard. De indeling van groepen voor de praktische opdracht, en mogelijk ook voor de werkgroepen, wordt door de docenten georganiseerd via Canvas in week 1 van de cursus.

Prevention of Mental Health Problems

Course Code	AM_470840
Credits	6
Period	P3
Course Level	400
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. N. van den Bogerd
Examiner	dr. N. van den Bogerd
Teaching Staff	dr. N. van den Bogerd
Teaching method(s)	Computer lab, Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

- You can explain the most important theoretical and scientific concepts in the field of prevention of mental health problems.
- You can demonstrate a basic understanding of methods to identify who is at risk for developing mental health problems.
- You can discuss the relevance of different risk and protective factors for mental health problems.
- You can describe relevant prevention programs for different mental health problems and the evidence for its effectiveness.
- You can conduct a systematic and critical review of the scientific literature in the field of mental health prevention programs and report on it.
- You can integrate gained knowledge on mental health prevention to make recommendations for further research and practice.

Course Content

For Health Science students this course fits in the program of the specialization Prevention and Public Health. Within this specialization you are trained to become a health promotor who is able to work in a theory- & evidence-

based way and is able to link research, practice and policy.

For Psychology students this fits in the program of the Clinical Psychology specialization. Within this specialization you are trained to become a psychologist specialising in either the research, policy or practice of mental health care. Most courses in this specialization can be freely chosen and are all specific subtopics in mental healthcare, usually aimed at specific disorders or types of treatment.

Theoretical backgrounds of the prevention of mental health problems will be discussed, as well as currently used methods in preventive mental health care. Guest lecturers who work in the field of preventive mental health care will discuss current programs aimed at preventing several psychological symptoms and disorders. Also, the most important results of research conducted in the field of preventive mental health care will be presented. There will also be a focus on the implementation and evaluation of mental illness prevention programs. In the practicals students will tackle a self-chosen problem within the field of preventive mental healthcare, writing a report on it and presenting their most important recommendations.

All lectures and seminars will be in English. All examination is in English as well.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

This course is rewarded with 6 ECTS and runs in P3. Prevention of Mental Health Problems is a full-time course, this means that 40 hours a week are necessary to pursuit the goals of this course. Regular attendance during the weeks is mandatory. Teaching activities include: lectures and work group meetings.

Method of Assessment

An individual written examination that accounts for 50% of the final grade of this course.

A written assignment and presentation of the written assignment that together account for 50% of the final grade of this course.

To pass this course you have to have at least a 5.5 for the individual exam, the presentation and the assignment.

Entry Requirements

At the start of this course, we expect you to have mastered knowledge, insight, attitude and skills at a level which is comparable to the final qualifications stated by the Bachelor of either Health Sciences, Psychology or Artificial Intelligence at the VU.

Literature

A list of scientific papers to study will be listed on canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

Health Science, Psychology and AI students.

Additional Information

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Custom Course Registration

Registration for this course via VU-net. Post-placement for this course is not possible.

Recommended background knowledge

- Basic knowledge of psychopathology (symptoms of the most common psychiatric disorders).
- Basic knowledge on what prevention programs are and how they are Developed

Public Health Nutrition

Course Code	AM_470815
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	English

Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. ir. M.R. Olthof
Examiner	dr. ir. M.R. Olthof
Teaching Staff	dr. A.M.M. Vaes, I. Veldman MSc, prof. dr. ir. M. Visser, dr. L.A. Schaap, dr. H.A.H. Wijnhoven, prof. dr. ir. I.A. Brouwer
Teaching method(s)	Excursion, Excursion, Seminar, Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

Is coffee healthy or not? Does sugar tax work? Is the cholesterol-lowering claim on the product Becel pro-activ justified? These questions are examples of nutrition questions that nutritionist are confronted with. Everyone knows that nutrition is an important contributor to better public health. But what is a healthy diet, and what foods are 'a healthy choice'?

For development and revisions of dietary guidelines and for validation of health claims on food products an evidence-based approach is necessary. For this evidence-based approach all evidence should be collected and critically weighed in an objective way, putting aside prejudice and beliefs. Only in this way nutrition research can be translated into good policy. This course covers nutrition research, which includes critically evaluating available evidence, choosing the appropriate study design for nutrition related research, analyzing and interpreting the results, and finally translating nutrition research in nutrition policy.

Aims:

- Recognize and evaluate study designs for quantitative research and weigh the current scientific evidence on specific nutrition topics using an evidence based approach
- Formulate a specific research question in the nutrition field, systematically search, analyse and critically judge the available literature, write a systematic review on the findings and orally discuss the results.
- Judge the implications of available scientific evidence for future research, policy measures and industry in the nutrition field.

Course Content

- Evidence based approach
- Scientific evidence for dietary recommendations
- Public health nutrition in practice
- Major nutrition-related diseases
- Sustainability
- Scientific review of a chosen topic on nutrition and health

Additional Information Teaching Methods

This course consists of 6 credits divided as follows: lectures; workshops literature assignment, sustainability workshop, guest lectures, self study.

Method of Assessment

Grades for written exam, literature assignment, sustainability workshop.

All grades should be 5.5 or higher in order to pass the course (no compensation).

Entry Requirements

Bachelor course 'Voedingsonderzoek' or 'Voedingsleer en onderzoek', or equivalent level.

Students should have followed the master course ''Research Methods for Health Sciences'' in September/October. If not, please contact the course coordinator.

Literature

Will be announced through Canvas.

Additional Information Target Audience

Master students Health Sciences.
Interested students from other programmes should contact the course coordinator first.

Additional Information

- The course is a compulsory course for the specialization 'Nutrition and Health' within the MSc Health Sciences programme.
- Students should have knowledge and skills equivalent to the bachelor course 'Voedingsonderzoek' or 'Voedingsleer en onderzoek'.
- Students should have followed the master course 'Research Methods for Health Sciences' in September/October. If not, contact the course coordinator.
- This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Regulation and Organisation of Health Care

Course Code	AM_470809
Credits	6
Period	P2
Course Level	500
Language Of Tuition	Dutch
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. H. Merten
Examiner	dr. H. Merten
Teaching Staff	dr. H. Merten
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Written partial exam, Lecture

Course Objective

Doelstelling

Dit vak heeft tot doel studenten inzichten te leveren om de volgende elementen te kunnen beschrijven en analyseren:

- Het Nederlandse Zorgsysteem (1. de driehoek van zorgaanbieders, patiënten, zorgverzekeraars en de overheid en 2. de specifieke posities, relaties tussen en conflicten die binnen de driehoek optreden.)
- Nederlandse zorgorganisaties en hun functioneren (ziekenhuizen, eerstelijnszorg, verpleging en verzorging. De focus ligt hierbij grotendeels op de ziekenhuizen)

Tevens moeten studenten in staat zijn een kwaliteitsprobleem binnen een zorgorganisatie te analyseren en een verbeterplan op te stellen met behulp van de in de colleges besproken theorieën en modellen.

Course Content

De zorg is ingebed in het institutioneel kader dat wij ‘zorgstelsel’ noemen. Het vak Regulatie en Organisatie van de zorg (R&O) benadert het zorgstelsel als een samenspel van 4 posities met de inherente spanningen en conflicten tussen de 4 posities. Het betreft de patiënt, de zorgorganisatie, de zorgverzekeraar en de overheid die de posities en relaties reguleert. Deze driehoek is de focus van de cursus. Kenmerkend voor het huidige zorgstelsel – ‘gereguleerde marktwerking’ – is dat de overheid verantwoordelijkheden en macht aan de actoren delegeert: de patiënt participeert in het zorgverleningsproces en krijgt rechten, de zorgorganisatie krijgt een professioneel management dat ‘eindverantwoordelijk’ is voor het geheel van de prestaties en de zorgverzekeraar krijgt het recht op ‘selectieve zorginkoop’. De delegatie van verantwoordelijkheden en macht kan worden beschreven als ‘empowerment’ van de actoren die tezamen zorg verlenen. In deze cursus worden deze specifieke posities, relaties met de andere posities, conflicten en belangrijke thema’s behandeld.

Vanuit zowel de wetenschappelijke literatuur als de beroepspraktijk wordt onder meer ingegaan op de volgende thema’s en theorieën:

- Patiëntveiligheid en kwaliteit van zorg
- Value based healthcare in Nederland
- Patient centered care
- Zorgorganisatie als professionele organisatie
- Stakeholdermanagement en analyse
- Governance
- Gereguleerde marktwerking

Additional Information Teaching Methods

Colleges
Tijdens dit vak zullen we vanuit de centrale driehoek (patiënt-zorgorganisatie-zorgverzekeraar, met de overheid als kaderscheppende instantie) inzicht geven in het functioneren van het Nederlandse zorgstelsel op verschillende

niveaus. De bovengenoemde onderwerpen komen aan de orde in de hoorcolleges en worden geïllustreerd aan de hand van casuïstiek. Naast de hoorcolleges zijn er enkele colleges waarin onderwerpen vanuit een meer praktisch oogpunt worden belicht om de theorie te illustreren, veelal voorafgaand aan of tijdens de werkgroepen. Deze colleges zijn bedoeld om de theoretische concepten uit de theoriecolleges toe te passen voor het analyseren van praktijkproblemen.

Werkgroepen
De werkgroepen zijn bedoeld als ondersteuning bij de uitvoering van een taak die studenten in tweetallen of kleine groepjes (onder voorbehoud van het aantal studenten) uitvoeren. De taak omvat het beschrijven en analyseren van een kwaliteits- en/of veiligheidsprobleem in een zorgorganisatie binnen de context van het zorgstelsel en het uitwerken van een gepast verbeterplan. Voor deze opdracht dienen studenten met behulp van onder meer een stakeholderanalyse het netwerk van belanghebbenden in een organisatorisch verband en daarbuiten in kaart te brengen en te beoordelen. Hierbij passen de studenten de theorieën en modellen die tijdens de collegereeks besproken zijn toe. Het resultaat van de taak wordt beschreven in een verslag en (tussentijds) gepresenteerd tijdens werkgroep bijeenkomsten. Tijdens de werkgroepen wordt er gewerkt aan verschillende academische vaardigheden, zoals analytisch denken, presenteren en schrijven. Deelname aan en actieve participatie binnen de werkgroepen zijn verplicht, waaronder het geven van constructieve peer-feedback.

Contacturen:
Colleges: 30 uur
Werkgroepen: 15 uur
Zelfstudie: 100 uur
Opdracht: 40 uur

Method of Assessment

Het eindcijfer is als volgt opgebouwd:

-70% tentamen, bestaande uit drie individuele take home opdrachten waarmee in totaal 100 punten behaald kunnen worden. Het totaal aantal punten voor de drie opdrachten moet door 10 gedeeld worden om tot het cijfer te komen. Dus bij 55 punten (cijfer = 5,5) of meer voor de drie opdrachten gezamenlijk is het tentamen behaald. Dit houdt in dat er tussen deze drie opdrachten gecompenseerd kan worden.

Essay-opdracht 1: maximaal 30 punten
Essay-opdracht 2: maximaal 40 punten
Essay-opdracht 3: maximaal 30 punten

-30% verslag (maximaal 100 punten, minimaal 55 punten nodig voor een 5,5, totaal aantal punten/10 = het cijfer voor het verslag)

Zowel het tentamen als het verslag dienen beide met minimaal een 5,5 beoordeeld te worden om dit vak succesvol af te ronden. Compensatie tussen beide onderdelen is dus NIET mogelijk.

Entry Requirements

Niet van toepassing

Literature

De literatuur voor dit vak bestaat uit wetenschappelijke artikelen en wordt via Canvas gecommuniceerd.

Additional Information Target Audience

MSc studenten Health Sciences

Additional Information

Dit vak wordt in het Nederlands gegeven, de toetsing is ook in het Nederlands. Houd er rekening mee dat er wijzigingen op kunnen treden in de praktische opzet en toetsing van het vak. De uiteindelijke opzet zal tijdig via de Canvas-pagina van de cursus gecommuniceerd worden.

Docenten
Dr. Hanneke Merten (aanspreekpunt): h.merten@amsterdamumc.nl
Dr. Gerard Scholten (ESHPM- Rotterdam): grmscholten@hotmail.com

Dit vak voor het laatst aangeboden binnen de MSc Health Sciences in academisch jaar 2025-2026

Explanation Canvas

Literatuur wordt beschikbaar gesteld via Canvas.

Recommended background knowledge

Als bekend verondersteld:

Mackenbach, J.P., Stronks, K. (2016) Volksgezondheid en gezondheidszorg, achtste druk. Bohn, Stafleu van Loghum. De inhoud van dit boek (of eerdere/latere versies), en specifiek de hoofdstukken 9 en 10 worden als bekend verondersteld.

Gezondheidswetten, toegankelijk via wetten.overheid.nl:

- Zorgverzekeringswet
- Wet op de Geneeskundige Behandelovereenkomst
- Wet Medezeggenschap Cliënten in de Zorg (WMCZ)
- Wet op Kwaliteit, Klachten en Geschillen in de ZORG (WKKGZ)

Research Methods for Health Sciences

Course Code	AM_1255
Credits	6
Period	P1
Course Level	400
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. W. IJzelenberg
Examiner	prof. dr. R.W.J.G. Ostelo
Teaching Staff	dr. M.H. Donker, dr. D.R. Essink, dr. W. IJzelenberg, dr. R.M.H. Peters
Teaching method(s)	Seminar, Computer lab, Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

Final attainment levels

After successful completion of this course the student:

1. Is able to critically reflect and discuss the need and limitations of inter- and transdisciplinary research in the field of health sciences
2. Is able to explain, examine and critically appraise the methodological issues and the results of qualitative studies, observational studies, experimental studies, systematic reviews and meta-analyses
3. Is able to select an adequate methodology, including quantitative and/or qualitative tools, to address a research question
4. Is able to develop a research proposal for an MSc Internship in Health Sciences with a sound justification (based on existing scientific evidence and/or relevant theories and concepts) for the relevance of the research question and a sound methodology that enables answering the research question thereby contributing to a solution for the health(care) problem addressed in this proposal.

Course Content

This Master course Research Methods in Health Sciences focuses on methods and techniques of scientific studies related to the broad field of Health Sciences.

The overall aim of this course is to master the skills for designing studies in the field of health sciences to a level that the students can formulate various research questions given a specific health (care) problem and design various types of public health studies that fit these research questions. Finally, students should be able to critically appraise the methodological quality of these types of studies.

This course is structured according to the research process from formulating the research question to analysing and summarising the results.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

The course comprises lectures, as well as workgroups and workshops. Students will work in groups on an assignment. The lectures will contain examples applied to the broad field of health sciences.

Credits for the course AM_1255:

Six ECTS (European Credit Transfer System) as indicated in the BETA Teaching and Examination Regulations (Master's Degree Programme- Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam).
One ECTS credit point equals 28 study hours, so this course includes 168 hours.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

- Twelve lectures (12 x 2 hours +and two reflection session (2x 2 hours)
- Seven workgroups (7 x 2 hours)
- Three workshops (3 x 2 hours)
- Assignment + self-study (120 hours)

Attendance is mandatory for workgroups and workshops. Lectures and reflection sessions are not mandatory, but we do recommend that you attend as much as possible, as the lectures are designed to help you write your assignment and the content is part of the exam.

Method of Assessment

Exam and an assignment (to be made in a team of students). Both the exam and the assignment should be sufficient i.e. at least graded 5,5.

The final grade consists of two parts: 1) a written exam (60% of your final mark), and 2) an assignment that you write together with a team of students (40% of your final mark). Both the exam and the assignment are in English. All parts must be graded 5.5 or higher. For the exam, there is one resit in the same academic year. There is one revision possibility for the assignment.

To complete this course the attendance obligations for workgroups and workshops must be met. If these conditions are not met, the final grade cannot be calculated/released.

Entry Requirements

Students should have basic knowledge of statistics and the principles and methods of epidemiological studies.

Students with a Bachelor's degree or premaster in Health Sciences and students with a Bachelor's degree “Gezondheid en Leven” from the VU, meet the entry requirements.

In general, students who meet the prerequisites as stipulated in the Education and Examination Regulations of the Faculty of Science Master's programme in Health Sciences and who have officially obtained access to the Health Sciences programme have the required prior knowledge to participate in the course.

Students from the Master’s programme in Biomedical Sciences at the VU only meet the entry requirements if they have completed the elective course Epidemiology (AB_470180).

Students with a Bachelor's degree comparable to the Bachelor's in Health Sciences VU (such as Health Sciences at another university, Human Movement Sciences etc.) should contact the course coordinator dr. Helma IJzelenberg (h.ijzelenberg@vu.nl) before the start of the course.

Literature

Mandatory:

- ‘Doing Research in the Real World’. Gray, D.E. Publisher: SAGE Publications, 5th Edition (Published: November 2021). ISBN 987-1-5297-4243-5; ISBN 9781529742442.
- Selected literature to support lectures (links provided on Canvas). See the course’s Canvas site for a detailed description per lecture, workgroup or workshop.

Recommended:

- ‘Recommended: ‘Textbook of Epidemiology’. Bouter, L.M., Zeeger, M.P. Publisher: Wiley-Blackwell, 2nd edition; Published: January 2023. ISBN 9781119776024.

Additional Information Target Audience

Compulsory course for all students from the Master Health Sciences.

Compulsory course for all student from the Master Biomedical Sciences with specialization ‘International Public Health’, see Entry requirements.

Students with a Bachelor degree comparable to the Bachelor's in Health Sciences VU (such as Health Sciences at another university, Human Movement Sciences etc.) should contact the course coordinator dr. Helma IJzelenberg (h.ijzelenberg@vu.nl) before the start of the course.

Additional Information

The master course 'Research Methods for Health Sciences is a compulsory course for all Master students in Health Sciences as well as for Master students in Biomedical Sciences with a specialization in 'International Public Health', see Entry requirements.

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.

Custom Course Registration

For this course, it is *not* possible to register for workgroups or workshops via the registration module on your VU Dashboard. See Canvas for more information.

Explanation Canvas

All course information and announcements will be made available on Canvas (https://canvas.vu.nl). Students are therefore strongly advised, to check the course's Canvas site regularly for important last-minute messages concerning the course.

Recommended background knowledge

Basic knowledge of qualitative studies is recommended.

Scientific Writing in English

Course Code	AM_1159
Credits	3
Period	P4+5+6
Course Level	400
Language Of Tuition	English
Faculty	Faculty of Science
Course Coordinator	dr. G.A. Dreschler
Examiner	dr. G.A. Dreschler
Teaching Staff	dr. A. Martonfi, P. Robertson MSc BA
Teaching method(s)	Study Group, Lecture

Course Objective

On successful completion of this course you will be a more confident writer in English in terms of producing an academic text which is coherent and linguistically correct. You will have insight into the most important stylistic aspects of academic texts in your discipline. You will also have insight into how specific linguistic structures contribute to text coherence, and will have the ability to identify and improve aspects of coherence in your own academic texts. Finally, you will have clear insight into your strengths and weaknesses of your academic English writing skills, and knowledge of how to further develop your strengths and reduce your weaknesses.

Course Content

The course will start off by ensuring that you are up to speed in terms of the macrostructural and discursive features of academic texts in general and the specific kind of text you are writing in particular – a report on quantitative research, a report on qualitative research, or a methods paper. Centre stage is then given to aspects of coherent text and to linguistic devices that English uses to express complex ideas: we introduce basic principles, give you practice in analysing and reformulating defective text segments, and give you a checklist that you can use when editing your own text. The idea underlying this approach is that writing essentially involves rewriting and rewriting.

The treatment of linguistic accuracy (lexical, grammatical and punctuational features) takes a less central place in the group sessions of the course, but the detailed feedback given on your texts allows you to work on any individual problems you may have using the ELS-Online feedback site.

Additional Information Teaching Methods

The course consists of three plenary lectures, complemented by three seminars in groups of approx. 20-25 students per group.

Method of Assessment

The final product comprises a research report [in the form of an article], usually a draft version of your internship article. A number of weeks into the course you submit the draft introduction and methods sections of your text, and you will receive feedback on these sections using a marking programme called Markin, which is linked to our feedback website ELS-Online. You will receive another round of feedback on a substantial part of the final version of the full text, following submission in June or July depending on whether you start the course in February or March.

Assessment focuses on structure, academic style, clarity of expression, and linguistic accuracy.

Your text will receive a pass/fail assessment. If you fail, you will be given a final extra round of feedback to help you prepare a reworked version.

Literature

There is no obligatory reading for this course outside the course materials, but for language support you are advised to study the feedback categories in ELS-Online.

Additional Information Target Audience

This course is only open to students doing the MSc in Health Sciences.

Additional Information

1. The course has two starting times, one at the beginning of February and one at the beginning of March. Your starting time will be agreed in consultation with the internship coordinator.
2. The materials for the course will be made available on the course's Canvas site. You will also be asked to submit the first and final versions of your writing assignment via Canvas. Please organize your Canvas account so that you receive course announcements additionally via your e-mail.

This course will be offered for the final time within the MSc Health Sciences in the 2025–2026 academic year.